Forget me not

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Major Character Death

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by AsIn_PeterB

Summary

Catra has lived alongside society for almost a thousand years. A sacrifice her and the princesses made to maintain peace. However, just when Catra started to feel at peace, a part of her past she thought was lost forever returns.

Notes

Mention of character death in this chapter, it's not to graphic but does mention blood so if you want to skip that part it starts after "in the next instant the world changes." and last two sentences. If you want to skip the entire scene, skip to the following paragraph which starts with "Catra doesn't remember the funeral". See notes at the end for a bit more information but they contain spoilers.

Prologue

“Announcing their royal highnesses Queen Angella and King Micah of the Kingdom Brightmoon along with Princess Glimmer.” The voice rings through the halls meeting the ears of Princess Adora and her guard Catra as they wait across the room as the royal family of Brightmoon approach them.
“Welcome your majesties. It is an honour to receive you here today.” Adora stands from her throne, taking two steps forward before Catra follows.
“I’m always just behind you.” She had said earlier when they were being debriefed a a few days ago about the proposal of joining the Kingdom of Asteria to that of Brightmoon. Things had quickly turned sour at the initial meeting when it was also announced that Adora was to marry Princess Glimmer to solidify the joining of the two kingdoms. “Why?” Catra had exclaimed. “Why does it have to be Adora, why not Lonnie.”
“Catra, learn to hold your tongue. This is something she must do.” Shadowweaver hissed. “With threats coming from the arrival of Lord Hordak, it is important to show the strength we have. Brightmoon requested the marriage as the council of Princess are wary of allowing our kingdom into the alliance.”
“But why, why can’t we stay separate and neutral like we have always been.” Catra starts to raise her voice before a hand on her wrist requests her to stop. Adora stands up from her seat, hiding her hand still squeezing Catra’s arm. “I understand. With the opening of the boarders we must be cautious of… others who may wish ill will on us. How long before they come?”
“Six days, they will stay here for two weeks before you return with them to Brightmoon for the wedding which will follow in a month,” Shadowweaver reads from the parchment in front of her.
“I still don’t see why it has to be so fast. Adora doesn't even know this person and you’re forcing her to marry them basically sight unseen.” Catra spits at Shadowweaver. Adora tugs on the wrist she has trapped behind her urging Catra to stop. “Careful Catra, you mustn't over step, I’ve been too soft on you, allowing you to develop a… personal relationship with Adora as I thought you

would protect her better that way, but it seems I may have been mistaken.” Shadowweaver sighs, setting the parchment down. “I understand, and Catra was only looking out for me Shadowweaver, that’s all she has ever done.” Adora politely responds before Catra can react. Wrenching her arm free Catra heads towards the door. “I’ll be ready to meet Princess Glimmer next week.” Catra hears the words before the door closes behind her.

Unable to do anything about the thoughts swirling in her mind Catra heads to the training area where she spends the next few hours running drill after drill. Just as her muscles protest to be done with the unrelenting training a small “Catra” filters its way towards her, breaking her concentration and having the drill end with her elimination. “Oh Catra, still so predictable.” Adora laughs as she wanders closer. This is how it always was. Adora showing up after Catra threw a fit, never having to say sorry before Adora would bandage her hands which had been rubbed raw through the drills. Although her hands rarely needed the bandages these days they still went through the motions before Adora would speak to her. “I’m sorry you’re upset Catra, I don't really understand why, but you should figure it out before the Royal Family of Brightmoon arrives next week.” Adora breaks their silence with this. Catra wants to scream. She knows why she's angry but she can never say it out loud. Although her and Adora were closer than anyone she never knew how she was feeling. Adora had been so easy to read as a child that Catra always knew what to do or say. As they had grown up though Adora had become more closed off. She became the perfect Princess who was polite and smiled but you never knew where you stood. It was something she had to learn Catra would tell herself. She had to survive in the court and politics without Catra being able to help her there. It broke Catra’s heart. She hadn't realized at first but one day Kyle had asked her if they were fighting and if they were how could she make it up to her girlfriend as he was having trouble with his new boyfriend. Catra had quickly ushered that they were not dating to having Kyle surprised saying “oh I thought she knew you loved her back so I assumed sorry.” This

had sent Catra spiralling for a few weeks before she admitted to herself she was in love with Adora. Someone she could never be with but she could remain by her side if she never spoke the words out loud. So in their silence Adora was asking her to break the promise she had made to herself. Seeing that Catra was at odds with herself Adora decided to answer for her. "I know what you cannot say. It's alright. I think sometimes secrets are better. If you don't say it you can decide it had a different outcome now that we know what the future holds. I had hoped it wouldn't come to this and I would be crowned queen so I am sorry to you and sorry that I must be even more selfish and ask you to stay by my side. I cannot think about life without you so here where no-one can hear or misunderstand I'll make a vow to you. For the things we cannot say, it is the same for me. I will remain un-swayed. If after everything is over and we can witness peace maybe another story can be shared but until then if you will stay with me I will protect you in the ways I can, so if that is agreeable with you please swear in this silence we will stay until we can speak it with no end in sight." Adora had kneeled in front of her at some point during her speech. Their hands still firmly holding each other. Of course she knew Catra sighed to herself. Adora always knew her and Catra was only fooling herself in thinking she could hide this. Pulling Adora up to stand Catra now kneels in front of her. Releasing her hands to fully kneel Catra recites her vow. "I will stay in this silence with you, to protect you in all the ways I can. I will never be swayed. When we speak there will be no end in sight." Adora brings her hand to lift Catra's face to her. Prompting her to stand up as well, Adora makes one more promise. "From now on you will never bow to me. We are equals and I will never make you regret this vow."

After their promise things shift. Adora talks more to Catra and asks her to be more involved. Catra learns quickly how to assume the role of loyal protector. She knows she must learn to be more silent and now that she knows where Adora's heart lies she can. So when she meets the gaze of the Princess Glimmer for the first time she bows without breaking eye contact. A smile crosses Glimmer's face before she returns the gesture. Breaking their eye

contact and then heading to escort Adora to the dinner with Catra following silently behind.

The dinner is relatively civil. Although all parties seem tense, Adora does her best to make easy conversation with Princess Glimmer who has been seated next to her. Catra does her best not to eavesdrop but being sat on Adora's left hand side she can hear bits of the conversation throughout dinner. Their conversation doesn't stray from polite topics such as how their mutual friends are getting along and how the season is treating their respective kingdoms. After the dinner Catra follows Adora and Glimmer back to their respective rooms, accompanied by Glimmer's personal Guard Bow, they stop at Adora's room first.
"Goodnight Adora," Glimmer says with a smile as she places a parting kiss on Adora's hand before continuing down the hall. With a bow, Bow follows along quickly as they head towards Glimmer's accommodations.

Following Adora into her room they settle into their routine. Catra helping Adora get ready for bed and waiting for her to fall asleep before she changes position with the night guard. This is how they spend their nights. Quiet moments together and they continue even after they travel to Brightmoon. Only pausing briefly when the wedding ceremonies bleed into the nights. Adora is allowed a separate chamber from Glimmer. Glimmer had suggested it seeing as they now were the most powerful couple in the realms and would be an easier target if they were to remain together. So things didn't change for them, until war came knocking at their door a few weeks later.

Lord Hordak had come and announced the Horde's plan to take over the realms as well as the surrounding planets of the system. The council of princess's had spent many nights developing plans and tactics to protect the realms but soon the battles started to take their toll.

"How much longer can we carry on like this?" Frosta was fuming over news that planetary travel had been suspended leaving her family stranded on the neighbouring planet of Solarium. They had

gone to get supplies needed and had sent word as soon as they reached that the planet had been put on a lockdown as the Horde had threatened a major attack should any planet send help.

"We have to, at least until we get word from Scorpia that the planet Luem has been secured so we can launch the final attack." Glimmer said scanning over the latest intel. It had been a few weeks since Scorpia had left to aid the planet Luem as they worked on a machine that would shut down the Horde's machines so they could finally negotiate peace. Scorpia had been sent to retrieve it but had been out of touch for the last three days causing everyone to be set on edge. When the meeting was finally over Adora and Catra quietly made their way back to Adora's quarters.

"I don't feel like bed right now… could we take a walk through the garden?" Adora asked, one hand on her door to let Catra know she can say no. That it wasn't a demand from her queen but a question from the person she loves.

"That sounds nice, fresh air before the night is over." Catra steps back to fall into step with Adora as they make their way out into the quiet garden. With only the light of the moon and the tall hedges offering shadows for them to hide in Adora's hand found Catra's. Without words they followed the path deeper and deeper into the dark of the garden. Finding themselves at the center of the maze, a small haven that had been built for Adora. A gift from Glimmer for their wedding. A grove of willows with a carved out space for a seating area. The branches of the willows created a curtain of protection but still allowed the moonlight to filter through, creating a surreal feeling as Catra and Adora sat down, hands still entwined. Neither of them spoke for a while, just sat with each other and enjoyed their quiet moment away from the stress of prying eyes and conflict.

"I wish we did this more often" Adora sighed before letting her head fall to Catra's shoulder. Catra tensed and did a quick survey before relaxing. Catra turned to find Adora looking up at her. "Is this okay? I can move if you're uncomfortable." Adora said as she

slowly began to raise her head again.
"No! Um no… it's okay, I just was… a bit surprised as all." Catra shifts completely to face Adora who breaks into a wide smile when they come face to face. Catra suddenly becomes more aware of their hands still entwined now with their other ones placed on top of each other.
"Oh Catra, how is it you're always prepared but still I manage to surprise you." Adora teases and Catra wonders if she can hear her heart beating.
"Well, you are the one person I have never been able to predict… It's kind of nice having you surprise me like this… makes you more of my friend who I grew up with rather than your majesty…" Catra trails off noticing how Adora's smile started to fade as she continued on in her sentence.
"Oh, your friend I see." Adora offers her a small smile casting her eyes down at their entwined hands. Catra feels her start to pull away. Grabbing them firmly before she can get away. Adora snaps her attention back up at Catra's face.
"That's not what I meant, I didn't want to say human…well because you still are, even when you have to act like a ruler. It's just nice that you seem to relax out of that role and it reminds me of when you were younger before you started to act like the politician you are today. Sorry this is not coming out properly.. ugh, what I'm trying to say is I like that you surprise me even if it causes me to momentarily lose sense and make a complete fool out of myself…so yeah please um please don't stop surprising me." Catra hopes her words make sense and that Adora knows what she's trying to say as she slowly is consumed with worries Adora stops her thoughts in their tracks.
"Okay, can I kiss you then?" Adora asks bringing Catra's eyes back to hers in an instant.
"Um… what?" Catra knows it sounds dumb as soon as the words leave her mouth but she can't quite believe what she's heard.
"Can I kiss you?" Adora asks again this time her smile returns.
"But you could have just said no if you didn't want to." Adora's words are stopped when she feels Catra's lips against her. They're hesitant, causing Adora to smile. Catra was never known to be gentle or hesitant, a strong warrior and protector but when it

came to their quiet moments Adora knew she should take the lead. So before Catra can pull away, Adora reaches on hand up to lead them deeper into the kiss. Letting the words they would not say drive the kisses until they felt their hearts beat as one. Lingering in the moment after their kiss Catra left her forehead against Adora's as if she is willing her thoughts to transfer. Catra knew she couldn't say everything out loud but she never wanted Adora to doubt the place she held. They left the grove of willows entwined and only parted when the shadows made way for the lit courtyard that had them return to the bitter reality they were currently facing.

The following evenings continued in a similar fashion. When they were finished for the night they allowed themselves to be consumed by shadows to steal kisses and moments of closeness until a few weeks had passed and Scorpia had finally returned with the final piece they needed. Following her arrival the final pieces were set in motion. Entrapta spent countless days and nights finishing the machine they needed to stop the horde technologies. Upon Scorpia's arrival they hadn't noticed a figure slip in. Disguised as a guard the figure approached the group who was bent over the final piece they needed to disarm the Hordes machines. All of them had gathered for the final night of planning. However, the figure managed to disrupt the meeting. Time seemed to slow as the figure drew its bow notching an arrow and aiming it towards Glimmer. Adora happened to look over her shoulder and notice the guard. Moving without thought, Adora leaves Catra's side and in the next instant the world changes.

"Adora!" Catra's voice rings out. Adora looks down to find an arrow lodge in her chest. Raising a hand to her chest she feel a warm liquid spill across her hand.
"Oh" She manages to get out before falling to her knees. Catra is beside her in the next moment catching her before she falls further, pulling her close and cradling her.
"Adore, no, hold still, it's okay." Catra is frantic looking for something, anything to stop the bleeding. A warm sticky hand catches her cheek and turns it back towards Adora who is smiling up at her.

“Catra it’s okay.” A tear slides down her face, the smile not leaving her lips.
“I’m sorry to be selfish now my friend. I was afraid but now it seemed foolish.” She chuckles softly. “Catra… I love you… I’m sorry to break my vow to you but I had to say it once. Thank you for letting me see the stars with you.” Adoras hand falls from her cheek, smile still on her lips. Her last breath, a sigh that seemed to suggest she had been happy to break her silence.
“Adora” Catra weakly mumbles out, bring her closer. “I love you too, why couldn’t you have waited for me to tell.” Catra sobs. She doesn’t know how long it’s been when guards come rushing in. Catra fights them off as they try to remove her from Adora. She doesn't stop until Shadowweaver calls them off and asks her to carry Adora out.
Catra doesn't remember the funeral. She became numb as the music was played and figures clad in white and muted colours reflecting their respective kingdoms pass alongside her. Glimmer is there and although Catra knows they had only been married in spirit she doesn't doubt the tears that fall from her eyes. Glimmer kept reaching for Catra’s hand throughout the ceremony and when they send Adora off she waits with Catra until they are the only two left on the beach and the boat carrying Adora had either burned fully or had drifted too far away to see.
“Catra” Glimmers voice breaks their silence. “I have to ask… will you stay with me?” Catra turns now to her companion. “I know you don’t really like me” Glimmer brings up a hand to stop the protest working its way out of Catra’s mouth. “Don’t worry I understand, You loved her and I was in the way of you two. But I trust you, you still protected her even when you were hurting and I have a way to fight back. To make sure we stay safe. It requires you to sacrifice though. It will be you and me for eternity.”
“I’ll do anything.” Catra doesn’t hesitate. She had lost the only thing she had ever cared about and now would protect the world her love had given her life for. “I promise you Adora” She thinks to herself, “I promise that we will bring peace and I will remain to ensure that this planet will never know a loss like yours again.”

The next evening Glimmer conducts the ceremony. Catra wakes up the following day with flashing images of figures in robes and offerings made to the gods. A blue flash of light and then darkness. Catra feels stiff as she rolls off the bed. With a loud thump she lands on the ground. Barely able to catch herself before her face hit the ground she lets out a groan.
"Catra you're awake!" Hands pull her up and help her sit on the bed. Scorpia smiles down at her. "So happy to see you awake so soon, Entrapta had said it would be at least another week."
"Well, all my readings indicated this would be the case.. fascinating, Catra can I take a sample of your blood?" Entraptra hangs down from the ceiling and when Catra looks up she sees Glimmer peaking over the edge of a hanging bed.
"Why are you only asking for mine? Glimmer is awake as well…" Catra bats her needle away.
"Well Glimmer was always going to have to do this ceremony, she's built for it you, well you're the first non-royal blood to complete the ceremony. Honestly only after a week of unconsciousness you shouldn't be up." Entrapta approach her again with a needle ready.
"Did you say a week?" Catra screeches more alert but again as she jumps to her feet her limbs fail her. Thankfully Scorpia is able to catch her before she hits the ground.
"Careful there wildcat, immortality takes a while to adjust to." Scorpia sets her right again.
"I'm sorry did you say immortality?" Catra doesn't jump this time and instead wracks her brain to when she agreed to this.
"Yeah what did you think I meant when I asked you to make the biggest sacrifice, your humanity?" Glimmer slides down to rest in front of her.
"I don't know, thought I'd go berserk and have super powers or whatever at the cost of my mind not live forever…" Catra sinks back against the cushions. "Ah you'll have to remember her forever now, all alone, like it was always going to be." A voice rings in her head. "Stop, you know I chose you in the end" Catra startles as she hears Adora's voice echo in her mind. Ah guess I did lose my mind, Catra smiles to herself.

“Okay let’s get to work” Catra stands although shaky, she pushes Scorpia’s hand away. “We have a war to win.”

The war was long with many causalities on either side. Too many face lost and an end that only comes with the hoards surrender after a final blow dealt by the king and queen of Brightmoon. A promised withdrawal from the planets of the alliance and to never attempt to expand their territory again, the planets of the alliance are left to themselves.

After the war ends the days pass slowly. Everyone on edge at how calm it is and mourning the loss of companions. Glimmer holds a funeral for her parents whose final sacrifice ended the war. It lasts a week before they sit down with all neighboring kingdoms and planets and sign peace accords. Their corner of the universe has an understanding and the princesses are there to make sure it lasts forever. Slowly the days make up years and as the years pass the princesses make their rotations through the system. Staying only long enough to help the inhabitants and moving to the next before they can become attached to one place for long. After a couple centuries of following Glimmer around Catra finally asks to retire and live permanently in Brightmoon. With promises to come whenever she was needed Catra moves to a small property where Glimmer had given her a house. “A home for a hero” She had said when gifting it to her. It had been her parent’s home before they had been crowned and Glimmer couldn’t bear the thought of it being empty but couldn’t bring herself to move there when it was her rotation. Catra thought it was fitting. A house built for a love that was lost. Even after centuries she still knew the ache. She dreamed every night of Adora. They were in the field of forget me nots. Those had been her favourite. Adora is calling out to Catra and she follows. However, as soon as she catches her, Adora falls into her arms and they are back in the palace. An arrow piercing Adora’s chest but she smiles and says I love you before Catra wretches awake. Tears staining her face and pillow every morning reminding her of the dream she cannot escape. Catra had started to paint over the years after Scorpia had suggested it the first time she had witnessed Catra’s nightmares. It had become a habit and Catra spent most of her days silently passing the hours she

spent awake remembering the places she had been and the things she had done. Glimmer had suggested one day to donate her artwork to museums as she knew the history as well as anyone could. Soon Catra found herself being asked for art from other planets museums and art collectors. Catra decided to become an artist, there was no need for her to be the warrior she was and this was her way of remembering Adora. She started going by her last name Sylvatica and that was how she would be remembered in history. The historians liked to come up with theories about her identity as her paintings had survived centuries alongside her. The latest theory was she belonged to a group of artist that passed the title to the next generation when they had mastered mimicry of their teacher. Of course people in official positions knew the truth about her, same as the other princesses who ruled from the shadows. Their immortality wasn't necessarily a secret but not common knowledge as Catra was the one of the few of them who interacted with different generations, staying long enough in once place for people to know her but not enough that they could pass it along to the next without her knowledge. So there they stayed. Forever a silent partner as the worlds grew and prospered. Taught of the great sacrifices of Queen Angella, King Micah and the Princess Adora of the ancient kingdoms and how their sacrifices had set up the continued peace and prosperity that the worlds knew.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

> Um... tbh idk how I got this done so apologies because I tried to proof read but probably shouldn't have at 2 am

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra liked to visit the museum. Glimmer always made fun of her for it. 'Was living it once not enough for you? Also I can't believe some of the portraits I let you paint of me or have painted of me, I would say yours are better but your first one, I'm sorry that I ate your last piece of cake but you didn't need to memorialize my eating habits." Glimmer would sigh. The painting she was referring to was the one Catra was standing in front of. She had painted Glimmer looking sneaky in the kitchen with various cakes around the room. Most of the discourse around the image that was popular 700 years later was that the painting was a cake testing for her wedding to Adora. Catra had found the news of this very funny while Glimmer had not taken it so well. Finally after looking at the rest of the museum, Catra found herself at the last image in the gallery. The last one she always waited for. The one she would sit in front of until the security guards would ask her to leave, as the gallery would be closing for the night. Finding her spot on her favourite bench she looked at the giant floor to ceiling portrait of her and Adora. It was the last official painting of Adora. She had asked Catra to pose with her. "Come on Catra" Adora had smiled. "You will be in history books as well you might as well have a beautiful image to go along with it." Catra had agreed easily when Adora smiled at her so there she was. Forever standing behind Adora as she had promised. A hand resting protectively on her, while Adora sat on her throne. The artist had painted them outside under a willow tree. Catra had always found that ironic. A reminder of their broken promise. Painted the day before they had left for Brightmoon. Catra spent most of her evenings this way as she decided if she had to remember the past she could remember the parts she wanted to. If she were to be

haunted it would be by ghosts she wanted to see again. Moments that felt like she was living in them rather than the memory. Although tonight was a little different. The museum director had called and asked for a meeting on a new installation the gallery was preparing and Catra had become close with the current director of the museum. She had been an apprentice of the previous director so had known Catra for years at this point. Whenever they rotated or added a new exhibit to the museum she made sure to call Catra to get the extra details she may know about the painter or a piece from off world or one of Catra's earlier works that was being brought back out for the public as a "newly" discovered piece that the director had "found". Which she had when she had come over to Catra's for Glimmer's birthday party and snuck into her attic to look for something she thought would look "perfect in this spot of the museum". So here she was waiting for her friend to lead her to the back office when she hears her name.

"Catra?" She knows that voice. Hears it every night in her dreams. Along with the stench of blood and the pain that erupts from her chest waking her every night as well. Although she had left that name behind when the war was over and as years passed so did the ones that knew her by that name, while she remained. Trapped by her own making. A promise to someone she could not forget. She turns to the stranger who could not know her and she meets the eyes of the one she can't forget.

"Sorry" The girl from her past says. "You look exactly like Catra from the Astrea era, I'm an art history professor you see and well it was uncanny, and now I'm rambling, let me introduce myself I'm"

"Adora." Catra cuts her off before she can think, the name spoken like a memory.

"Uh yeah, how'd you know?" Stranger Adora smiles at her now with curiosity.

"Um your name tag… also, you look like her, well the paintings." Catra scrambles to cover her slip.

"Oh, yeah I get that a lot, I don't really see it myself, at the very least she had better hair than me but my parents liked the name and seeing as how I ended up studying her it seems fitting." She

chuckles to herself.
“So what is your name?” Adora asks her.
“Oh well it is Catra but I go by my last name Sylvatica, but you can call me Catra.” She looks down at the floor.
“Okay Catra, you come here a lot don't you.” Adora settles down next to her on the bench.
“Yeah, I um know director Lighthope… actually we have a meeting shortly so..” Catra starts to stand.
“Oh yes, of course you do, you even said Sylvatica and I just clued in.” Adora stands up as well. “She’s sent me to fetch you, she said you’d be easy to be spot but never thought it would be because you look like Catra. Sorry Ms Sylvatica please follow me.” Adora smiles warmly and Catra finds herself following the ghost as she rambles on about the museum. Although Catra has heard the same speech for years as each new directors met with her as the prepared to take over for their mentor, the words seemed foreign coming from Adora’s mouth.
“Here we are, Lighthope is just waiting on the other side.” Adora smiles as they reach the familiar office. Catra could find her way easily by now but in order to keep up pretenses she follows along each new staff member until they’ll believe she will know the way.
“Thank you… um are you sitting in on this meeting?” Catra braces herself against the door handle.
“Oh no not today, unfortunately I have a class to teach tonight so I won’t be able to. It was nice to meet you Ms. Sylvatica, I will see you next time.” Adora smiles and starts off back down the hallway.
“You can call me Catra” The words leave her mouth before she has time to register them.
Adora stops and turns back around a polite smile on her face that seems more like a question. “I mean since we will be working together and you already know my name.” Catra tries to play it off. “You don’t have to be so formal with me.” Adora genuinely smiles now. “Okay Catra, then please call me Adora.”
“Okay, goodbye Adora, until next time.” Catra enters Lighthope’s office but not before she hears “Goodbye, Catra.”

Lighthope was on the phone when Catra entered her office so she went over to the table to look at the images Lighthope had laid

out. Catra recognized a few from previous exhibits of the other princesses and a few of the pages with her artwork had question marks beside them.
"Sorry about that! I was just talking with Perfuma, she's sending a few pieces from Luem to be in the show but you know how much she likes to talk, also tried to get me to feature more images of nature but I told her the show was about the protectors of the peace and not about peace." Lighthope sits across from Catra whose still looking over the pages sprawled in front of her.
"I might have a piece back home of her that heavily features plants. I'll take a look tonight and send you the images later if I find." Catra doesn't need to look up to know a smile has spread across Lighthope's face.
"Such a reliable friend I have. I'm so lucky to have meet you." Lighthope gushes knowing her sentiments slightly endears but also annoys her friend. "Oh did you like the surprise I sent for you?" Lighthope asks casually causing Catra to look up now.
"Adora?" Lighthope presses on. Noticing Catra seems intrigued rather than upset she continues. "When she came to work here I couldn't believe it. She looks exactly like your paintings it was uncanny and then her parents named her Adora, I've met them and even they seemed surprised how closely she resembles her. They said a nurse suggested the name since they couldn't decide and then thought it would bring her luck." Lighthope waits for a response now.
"I was surprised, you should have told me you know." Catra sighs. She's not annoyed by her friend just lost in thought about the encounter.
"Well, do tell Glimmer about this then let me know what she says." Lighthopes eyes gleam at her comment drawing a small laugh out of Catra.
"Okay now to the matter at hand" Catra gestures towards the images on the table. "How can I help?"
Their meeting runs smoothly with Catra filling in some blanks for Lighthope as well as explaining the pieces Lighthope had chosen from Catra's works.
"Do you have any self potraits?" Lighthope asks just as they are wrapping up the meeting.

“Why? I don’t think I should be in the show?” Catra asks.
“Catra, you have lived with them this entire time, you were there, you were beside Adora and then Glimmer through it all and you don’t think you should be in the show?” Lighthope looks affronted by Catra’s comment.
“Well I mean would people want to see an image of me? I’m not really in the history books other than the one image of Adora.” Catra still confused by her friends reaction becomes even more so when Lighthope bursts into laughter.
“Oh Catra” Lighthope laughs out. “You really do not keep up with new media do you?” Lighthope starts to calm down now but the smile never leaves her eyes.
“No not really, not for Catra anyways, I left that name behind a long time ago, still don’t know why you like to use it. Since I interact the most with is Sylvatica I only follow that name.” Catra responds with slight intrigue as to why her friend is asking.
“Oh boy, you should really go to a local book store, not only are you in history books but people have written fiction and well they also say nonfiction but seeing as how you’re still alive I doubt those are true.” Lighthope smiles kindly. “The history books though, they say you were a brave and fierce warrior who fought until the end. They make you larger than life my friend, to the point that when they told me who you really were I laughed because how could the cranky artist that knew way too much and seemed to only exist on coffee be this amazing warrior from centuries ago. I only believed them once I met Perfuma because well she’s exactly as they depict but I think that’s because she helped write the history books.” Lighthope is still smiling at her friend but worry has started to colour her face.
“Oh, well I can see how it took Perfuma to convince you.” Catra laughs at her friend trying to put her back at ease. “I still don’t see the big deal but I’ll send you some photos of me too I guess.” Catra promises.
“Good I’ll be looking forward to it. Let’s set another meet up for a week from today if you have time. Scorpia is sending a piece from Solarium so it should be here by then. It’s not one of yours because I can’t be seen playing favourites, but it’s from the artist Rogelio and I think you worked with him about 200 years ago if I

remember correctly so you can tell me more about the image because we've been having trouble translating it." Lighthope pulls up her calendar to block in time.
"Just text me once you get it in. I only have plans Friday evenings lately so I'll come in right away if you want, but I'll still put it in for Wednesday evening? That way if I don't hear you message or I'm painting and it's turned off I'll be alerted or Glimmer will send someone to make sure I get here." Catra plugs it into her phone.
"Okay, I'll see you later Catra." Lighthope laughs and returns her friends wave before she exits the office.

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"Glimmer." Catra swings the door to her office wide open not bothering to knock.
"What." is the only response she gets. Glimmer doesn't even look up from the papers she has in front of her.
"I met Adora today." Her heart pounds against her chest as she says the words.
"What?" Glimmer responds again looking up this time. "Catra… I'm sorry but that's not possible… we… well you know better than anyone.."
"It's true though, she has the same voice and the same eyes, she teaches art history and works at the museum here in Brightmoon, if you don't believe me we can go and check tomorrow and I can show you her." Catra insists, her eyes shining in a way her friend had not seen in centuries.
"Okay, tomorrow then." Glimmer returns to the papers in her hand. Interesting, Glimmer thinks maybe there is some hope for her friend.

- Glimmers POV-

Glimmer hadn't wanted to admit it. Too many years had passed since they had last seen Adora that Glimmer assumed she had never chosen to get reincarnated and instead would wait for eternity for someone who could not come and meet her. Glimmer

had never told her friend this, trying to spare Catra from the knowledge that Adora may have been waiting for her, somewhere she would never reach. However, standing here in the museum she immediately recognizes her. Even though they had spent only a few months together they had grown close. In an alliance meant to save Brightmoon. Glimmer realized she had failed her and it takes all her strength not to turn and run. She is here for her friend, someone she probably doesn't deserve but has promised to spend their lives making her as happy as she possibly can, for Catra as much as it was for Adora. Another promise she would never tell. The only thing Adora had asked of her on their wedding night so many years ago. "Please let Catra stay and if something happens stay with her, she's troublesome but loyal to a fault. She won't tell you how she feels but you will know if you watch her actions. If anything happens I don't want her or you to be alone." So Glimmer takes a sip of her coffee as Catra stares across the mezzanine as the Adora in question is discussing with a few other staff members. The Adora smiles and waves when she notices Catra, who visibly freezes for a second before returning a small wave. The Adora in question now makes her way over and Glimmer prepares herself. She'll know as soon as she hears her voice and sees her eyes if it's their Adora. Glimmer finds herself hoping it won't be, afraid of the past her and Catra had tried to forget but still haunts them. As if she was a ghost this Adora walks lightly and quickly and soon comes beside Catra and beams. "Oh you're back already, you should have texted me and I would have gotten permission to show you the new exhibit we are unveiling next week." She smiles at Catra. "It's fine we can't stay long because Glimmer has work and this cafe is close to her work and she knows I'll probably stay after." Catra quickly offers up the information. "Oh" Glimmer thinks to herself, she hasn't met her eyes yet but from how Catra is it must be Adora. "Oh forgive me, I forgot to introduce myself I'm Adora Myosotis." Adora holds her hand out to Glimmer. Taking her hand Glimmer brings her eyes to meet Adora's. "Hi Adora" she smiles hoping not to give away what she now knows. "As Catra said I'm Glimmer." A polite smile, one she's practiced and wears daily. "Hi Glimmer, I must say you look an awful lot like the Glimmer in the paintings, If I didn't know any

better I would say you were.” Adora laughs a little at her joke.
“Oh but I am.” Glimmer smiles for real. Adora is obviously shocked because although Glimmer and the others have never hid the fact they have lived this long it was common public knowledge. The face that Catra makes is worth admitting this now. Catra is somewhere between horror and awe as Glimmer has worked on being less impulsive over the years so her sharing of the information must have been a shock for her friend as well. However, that not on Glimmer’s mind at the moment. Glimmer knows it's only a matter of time before they fall into one another again she figured she’d help things along. “Oh uh” Adora is lost for words.
“How about this, Catra and I go for dinner at Entrapta’s on Friday’s as a tradition would you like to join us this week?” Glimmer takes a final sip of her coffee. This breaks Adora from her stupefaction “Oh I couldn’t possibly intrude on your meal.”
“It’s no big deal, you are more than welcomed to come but also no pressure if you don’t want to. However, I must return to work now so you have Catra’s number, she can let me know what you decide. Also if you do decide to come send her your address so we can send a car around, or if that’s uncomfortable Catra can bring you, Unfortunately for security reasons you can only come in either with my detail or Catra so you will have to decide that. Adora it was a pleasure and I hope to see you soon, Catra I’m sure I’ll see you sooner.” With a small bow and a final wave when she reaches the door Glimmer exits the museum and enters the car waiting for her.
“How was it?” Bow asks from the driver’s seat. He’s not her Bow though, one of his reincarnations. Bow decided he wanted to live like how he was supposed to but always promised to return for her, so for now she finds herself staring at eyes that will soon hold love for her but for now they are distant, cold but none the less polite. It seems this time he is resisting his fate. Bow knows who he was but had wanted to try and be someone else, however, due to his promise he had signed many reincarnations ago he returns to her side by the time he is twenty five to work for the Princesses. Glancing out the window to avoid his gaze Glimmer sighs.

“It’s her. She’s been invited for dinner on Friday so you may have to pick her up if Catra doesn’t.”
“Is there anything else?” Bow pulls the car away from the curb and heads towards the office.
“Please run a background check on her, nothing to invasive just make sure she was okay when she was young and why her parents didn't have her check when she was young for reincarnation.”
“Understood.”
Glimmer whispers a small thank you. She doesn’t care if he hears her or not. She’s tired of having to fight for him each time and instead will treat him the way he had asked his first day. “I understand who I was but as far as I am concerned you are my boss and it would be unprofessional to cross that line so please, treat me as the stranger I am.” She knows he had asked to be sent to one of the other planets in the alliance to another princess. Glimmer had thought it would be better to deal with the grief now for he may choose to not come back again for her. She can’t blame him though, for all the time they had together she understands and she’s not sure she would chose to keep returning if she knew what was on the other side. She pushes away her thoughts and returns them to her friend. How happy she looked when Adora walked over to her and as happy as she wanted to be she couldn’t shake a nagging feeling. Everyone was tested at birth to see if they were a reincarnated. It had started centuries ago as the alliance had wanted to look for her parents. Even though Glimmer knew it was pointless to look for them the tests had managed to find Lonnie in her third life and she agreed to join the princesses in their immortality after her memories returned to her. Although no one was looking now the tradition had kept up since people were curious. Glimmer couldn’t help but think how weird it was as there certainly would have been an alert once Adora was tested. Glimmer was going to have to ask Perfuma as she would have been the representative on planet when Adora was born.

Chapter End Notes

I will try for about weekly updates but honestly don't expect that because I still can't believe I got this done

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> Hey.. so this is rough, but I figure I can always change it later so if I do I'll update the notes as well. Also I don't know if there will be a chapter next week as my friend has been in a serious car accident so I will be taking care of them. Anyways hope you enjoy this chapter

Distracted by the impending Friday, Catra attempts to busy herself with work. She finds the painting she had done of Perfuma in her garden a few hundred years ago. Perfuma seemed to be a part of the garden rather than the owner and Catra wasn't sure how it had remained in her collection for so long. Until she sees the forget me nots. Hiding in the bottom left corner. Catra remembers the day she had tried to give it to Perfuma.
"Catra this is beautiful… but you've painted the wrong plants in the garden." Perfuma tried to look encouraging but the worry was present in her eyes. Catra remembered she had tried to repaint it but each time she added plants they always turned out to be the wrong ones. Forget me nots hiding in fields of wild flowers and willow branches creeping along the borders. She had sent an image to Lighthope with a very brief statement about how the plants were wrong so the piece was probably no good to which Lighthope responded quickly saying that they could come up with a theory about the garden to tell the public since Lighthope tended to stretch the truth when it came to Catra's works. Catra didn't mind though, having her friend create a story from the image was a way for history to remember the two of them. Another secret she could keep for herself. They planned to meet Friday for lunch to get a draft together and Catra couldn't help but think of Adora again.
"I'll invite her to the meeting as well, maybe she'll give us an idea for our story. If you're okay with me using the painting I'll send it along." Catra had agreed easily but didn't spend too much time thinking if accepting her friends request was because she was hoping to have an excuse to see Adora before she decided if she

was going to accept Glimmer's offer. She also didn't think too much of it when she showed up early to the meeting that she had enough time to finish a coffee and sit at the painting of her and Adora attempting to not get lost in her thoughts when a familiar voice called for her. A ghost she couldn't help but smile when she saw. Catra turned to Adora greeting her with a small smile and wave. Adora made her way over as Catra stood up.
"Hello Catra, how are you today?" Adora smiles at her as she meets her in front of the painting.
"I'm fine, how are you?" Catra wants to scream at herself. 'Why do I sound so lame? I was only returning her curtesy, and now am I grinning like an idiot? Come on Catra pull yourself together, you're a professional right now and this isn't your Adora.' That thought seems to jolt Catra back into the present. She hadn't allowed herself time to think about Adora so the realization that although the girl in front of her looked like and sounded like her Adora, she had lived a different life. Grew up in a different time had different memories than her, didn't know about their quiet moments. About the promises they had made and broken.
"Catra? Do you not want to grab coffee for the meeting?" Adora's words bring Catra back to the girl in front of her.
"Oh yeah we should, sorry got lost in my thoughts a little there so I didn't hear you." Catra lowers her eyes and awkwardly scratches her neck
"Ah that's okay, you seem to do that a lot, like when I got here you looked lost in thought." Adora smiles before quickly turning in the direction of the café attached to the museum. "Let's go, Lighthope should be waiting with the food by now and I'm starving." Adora doesn't wait for a response but looks over her shoulder and smiles a couple of times on the way to grab coffee and then again when they are heading to the office for their meeting. They discuss a few details over the meal and once they are done with their food they move to the bigger topics, such as Adora's theory for the painting of Perfuma in her garden.
"Hmm, well I still think you're pulling my leg that this isn't a Sylvatica so it at the very least was someone inspired by Sylvatica's works… I also don't think the subject is Perfuma." Adora stares intently at the image on the screen in front of them,

occasionally glancing at her notes
“Oh why would you say that?” Lighthope asks the question but as she looks at Catra’s face, she knows Catra is thinking the same as her.
“Well since the figure is set into the garden, it looks a little more like a shrine. Yes the figure does strongly resemble Perfuma, it's just not quite right. Hmm how do I put this… If we look at just the figure it would be her at first glance but in closer details, the eyes aren’t quite the right shade and neither is the hair and since the flowers are all wrong, because well we’ve all been to the Perfuma garden, and there are no forget me nots. And I looked but Sylvatica only has used the colour of the leaves in the corners for her depictions of willow trees, so the leaves aren’t right either. Although they appear to be a maple the colour doesn't match.” Adora concludes but continues to stare at the image on the screen.
“So, what are your thoughts then? What story do you think it tells?” Lighthope questions tentatively watching her friend for a reaction that would need her to end the meeting.
“Well since you wouldn’t tell me the artist, I created a story that works if my theories are correct about them working with or being inspired by Sylvatica.” Adora shuffles her papers until she finds the correct notes.
“Okay Adora, wow us, tell us this theory.” Lighthope continues as she notices Catra relaxing a little bit.
“Well first of all I’d say the painter was thinking of someone else. Someone they could easily disguise as Perfuma, since they kept the important parts but changed the small features that you wouldn’t notice unless you looked like I did. So the painter was probably painting their muse and didn’t notice the slip in the details or if I could offer maybe a little bit of a fantasy, maybe the artist was painting their lover. Someone they wanted to be remembered but couldn’t outright show their devotion. The forget me nots a promise of a hidden romance, if my theory about the willow tree colouration is correct it could mean one of two things. The first is the lost or mourning of something so maybe they couldn’t be together or someone was lost before they could have a happy ending. However, I prefer my second theory which is the

willow is for security or hope, a promise of them belonging, maybe I'd just prefer it but the painting could mean a promise known only to them and it was memorialized, and since you said it was from a private collection it was probably a commission so if we look into the history of the family it came from maybe we can find a potential match for the figure Perfuma and a painter that would have either studied with Sylvatica or admired their style. Catra you can fill that in can't you? Seeing as you're the current Sylvatica, is there perhaps diaries or something that would have come from that time period?" Adora turns her attention to Catra who is immersed with the image on the screen. She hadn't noticed the little details Adora pointed out but saw even more she hadn't as she continued to look at the piece.
"Huh? Oh sorry… um yeah I can take a look around and see if I can find anything.." Catra replies a little lamely before returning her attention back to the image. A phone rings from the back part of the office causing the trio to startle a little.
'Oh that will be me! I think it'll be news on the painting from Solarium, excuse me for a second." Lighthope gets up and answers leaving Catra and Adora silently staring at the painting again.
"So what did you think of my theory?" Adora breaks the silence and Catra shifts her focus.
"It was good, I hadn't noticed those details… I liked the happier version better too." Catra tries to smile but she's unsure of how convincing it was.
"Well I did spend a lot of time last night researching this one, plus it helps I wrote my thesis on Sylvatica's pallet choices and the changes that occurred over the years so I probably have a little bit of an advantage over you." Adora smiles at her.
"Did you really? That's cool, could I read it?" Catra smiles genuinely at the news Adora was a fan girl of her work.
"Oh uh yeah sure, I can send you a copy later. Oh! I meant to tell you I can't come tonight to meet Glimmer with you, I have to cover a class for a friend for two weeks and it's Friday evenings. But the following Friday I could do it if her offer still stands." Adora smile lessens a little as if she is unsure about her request.
"Oh that shouldn't be a problem, we go every week anyways. I'm

sure Glimmer would understand and I'll let her know." Catra isn't sure if she hides her disappointment well enough behind an encouraging smile. She must have because Adora brightens again in front of her.
"Perfect, oh shoot look at the time, tell Lighthope I had to run to get my notes for the class but to let me know when the next meeting is. Bye Catra, I'll see you soon." Adora quickly gathers her things as she talks.
"Goodbye Adora, have a good class." Catra receives a smile before the door closes. Lighthope makes her way back to the table where Catra lets her know about Adora leaving for the class.
"Oh right, I totally forgot about that but now that she's gone, I have a question for you." Lighthope sits across from Catra making direct eye contact which she finds amusing.
"Okay, let's hear it." Catra counters by leaning on the table and smiles mischievously at her friend.
"Well two things. How was Adora's theory? About the image was she right?" Lighthope's expression shifts to one of concern
"Oh.. well no I don't think so" Catra herself isn't sure, she hadn't noticed the details and didn't remember having those thoughts when she painted it but Adora's theory had made sense. "I did like it though, the happy version at least. We can go with that one. I liked the idea of the painter and a lover, let's find someone to pin the theory to and go with that. Oh but maybe that won't go with the theme.. We can ask Perfuma if she'd be okay with us including the theory after the depiction of the piece but if not I'll come up with something about how paint was scarce for the colours necessary and the artist just used what was on hand, I'll even forge the papers you would need to prove it." Catra laughs at her friend as she relaxes a little after her statements.
"Okay that's good, well I'll phone Perfuma to discuss it with her and then let you know about the need for forgeries." Lighthope laughs at herself, she never would have thought about offering unauthentic proof before she had met Catra and the princesses but knew it would be for their benefit.
"What's the second thing?" Catra asks now that Lighthope seems a bit more relaxed.
"I thought Adora knew you were Sylvatica?" Lighthope asks

thoughtfully.
“She does.” Catra isn’t quite sure where Lighthope is taking the question.
“And she knows it’s always been you?” This causes Catra to startle a bit.
“Well… I never told her explicitly, I assumed she may have made the guess since Glimmer told her she was immortal and all…” Catra wasn’t sure why she hadn’t explicitly expressed that it had been her all those years ago and that the theories Adora came up with had involved her. She is almost sure Adora wouldn’t have said her theory if she knew Catra was involved, if she had, she couldn’t have come up with such a happy ending for the muse she suspected had influenced the painting.
“Catra, I can almost guarantee she did not assume that, reincarnation is more likely or a coincidence like her. Immortality is not something the average person encounters so she probably didn’t want to assume.” Lighthope sighs a little at her friend. Catra had always seemed a little clueless to Lighthope but never to the extent she seemed to exhibit recently. Choosing to chalk it up to the shock of meeting Adora, Lighthope didn’t press the matter farther.
“Oh.” Catra smiles sheepishly at her friend, an attempt to reassure herself and Lighthope
“Yeah. Well it’s up to you when you tell her, you still have a few years before she’ll start to get suspicious as to how you don’t appear to age even though you live a very unhealthy lifestyle.” Lighthope laughs with Catra to help dissipate the heavy atmosphere they inadvertently had created.
“Hey!” Catra laughs as she yells at Lighthope.
“Well its true, if I slept as little and basically consumed only coffee I would not look as glowy as I do. But don’t worry too much. Just tell her when you’re ready, you have time.” Those words snap Catra back into her thoughts. Did she have time? The last time she made the mistake of thinking she had time she lost Adora and now it was being said about someone else who should be her but wasn’t.
“Thanks.” But its halfhearted. Lighthope gives Catra a light pat on the shoulder as they say goodbye with a promise to meet the

following Wednesday when the other painting finally arrives. However, Lighthope's actions do little to ease Catra's racing mind and she finds herself barely concentrating until she is sat down across from Glimmer for their Friday dinner.
"No Adora today? Is she joining us later?" Glimmer asks casually but Catra would almost guess her friend was expecting something more.
"She sends her regrets, she had to cover a class for someone so she was unable to come this time, she would like to come in two weeks if the offer still stands, she has to cover again next week but will be free the following one." Catra relays the information for Glimmer.
"You can let her know she is welcome any time." Glimmer smiles before changing the topic to discuss her day at work. After a bit of listening to Glimmer discuss her day, Glimmer can't take her silence any longer. "Care to tell me what's on your mind? Or is it off topic for today?" Glimmer asks. She's learned to always provide an out for Catra. After all their time together she learned Catra would always share with her when she was ready but it always had to seem like a choice. They had argued at first when Glimmer had always used her political position to get Catra to answer and it had lead to them almost not speaking for weeks until Bow had said that Catra wasn't someone that Glimmer had to look after. That out of anyone she was Glimmer's equal and someone who she would always have so she needed to treat her as such. Glimmer had apologized and it lead to Catra opening up about Nightmares. Glimmer had understood. She had had the same ones.
"It's just, well Adora shared a theory about one of my paintings." Catra trails off a bit looking for her next words while Glimmer waits patiently a gentle smile to encourage her friend to continue is on her face. "See I painted an image of Perfuma, but Adora pointed out details that didn't make sense for it to be Perfuma so I'm just curious as to what else I've missed over the years. Oh! She also apparently wrote her thesis on my works so she's sending me that to read and I'm a little interested but I'm not sure if it's a good thing." Catra trails off. It looks like she has more to add but Glimmer isn't sure where to see if she can push.

“Well that sounds interesting. Please send her paper to me as well. I want to see what the scholars are saying about my talented friend and if anyone has guessed it was me that got you into painting yet.” Glimmer laughs as Catra sighs at her before offering a smile of her own.
“They’ll never guess that but if you ever convince someone of it let me know. Scorpia will have words about it too, seeing as it was her who suggested it first and no one has mentioned her” Catra laughs some more.
“Hey we both know I bought you all the stuff so I think you should consider it me who got you into painting seeing as how I had to buy stuff every time we moved.” Glimmer pouts a little but her laughter breaks through easily.
“Okay my glorious patron, I’ll make sure to include that it was due to you the great Sylvatica was able to create. That is if I ever write a biography.” Catra seems more at ease.
“Good, and I’m glad to know you realize how great you are. You’re my favourite at the least.” Glimmer smiles at her friend as they begin to settle. Both a little lighter.
“Thank you… can I ask you one more thing?” Catra hesitates a little, she knows she can ask her friend anything but she’s unsure if Glimmer will be okay with the topic.
“Sure go for it.” Glimmer offers another reassuring smile.
“I know that reincarnation is a little weird but each time Bow came back he didn’t remember did he?” Catra is careful with her words. She knows about the current Bows comments and doesn’t want to hurt her friend.
“No. Sometimes he did but it was more like a past was coming through rather than him knowing. But he does live a different life, well as much as he can seeing as he signed up long ago to keep coming back and help us.” Catra doesn’t correct her friend. Bow had agreed years ago to come back and help the Princesses but he was always assigned to Glimmer when he came back. She had seen her friend fall in love each time and was wondering if it would be possible to love someone again. Glimmer continues when Catra doesn’t speak right away. “He is someone different each time and only I remember what it was like in the past. So my advice for you would be don’t focus on the past. She doesn’t

share your memories and although she may be similar to the person you knew she doesn't know you so you'll have to learn again how to be with each other." Glimmer smiles encouragingly at her friend. She doesn't want to scare Catra if she thinks she's found her again, but it would be unfair to burden Adora with the past. Especially one as tragic as theirs.
"Hmm, well thank you, I was thinking about it earlier. I hope she doesn't remember. Is that bad?" Catra hopes her friend can understand her.
"No, I don't think that's bad. It's natural to forget, we unfortunately aren't granted that, but it allows us to know the importance of it. If she has Adora's past I also hope she doesn't remember. It's not something I think everyone should know as a firsthand experience." Glimmer reaches for her friends hand across the table. They pass the rest of the meal in comfortable silence. All their years together had granted them peace in knowing the other was there. Glimmer asked if Catra would like to spend the night and they could watch old movies or new ones. Catra declined because she had a little work she would like to finish before starting her weekend. Catra did promise to come over the following evening to spend the night watching the movies they had been putting off, which Glimmer groaned but agreed she also had a little work she should finish too, she also gave Catra a bit of grief for not indulging her in her attempt to procrastinate and their evening ended in laughter as Catra was dropped off at her house.

"How come you only look like that with her?" Bow asks from the drivers seat as Catra enters her house.
"I'm sorry?" Glimmer is taken aback but quickly schools her expression into one of polite but disinterested look.
"It's just you only show emotion with her. The look you usually have, such as this one, you have all the time at work and with most of your other friends but with her" Bow gestures to the door Catra had just passed through, "it's different. She makes you seem human." Bow continues to hold eye contact through the rearview mirror.
"Well I'm not, never have. Not in the way you mean." Glimmer

drips venom into her voice. Bow was starting to act the way he did before she would fall again and break her heart. He had told her this was the last time so she was determined to remember the other Bow she had loved. The one who had loved her not because he felt obligated or had ever had any ill will towards her. So she would keep the walls they had created. "And Catra is the only one who has ever been my equal. She has been through it all with me. She understands me. We also only have each other. So yes. We are different." Glimmer waits for him to break eye contact. He does and she's able to turn her head back towards the window. She hadn't realized how tired she had become. She hadn't told Catra how she was hated each time Bow would come back because she knew he would leave her again. Although she hadn't wished any one the fate her friend had, she had always wondered if it would have been easier if Bow hadn't come back. They had lived a life together and it had been wonderful. Even the first few reincarnations had been as equally as wonderful. They seemed to have still felt the same way but over the times each time he came back to her he would grow more distant. No more wanting of the memories she cherished. Maybe he was tired too, but it was his choice so she was angry he was punishing her this time around.
"My apologies, shall we go to the office or would you like to return home." Bow gets the car going.
"I'll go back to office and stay at the apartment there. You are also dismissed for the next two weeks. You can go on vacation or whatever, but there will be no need for you to come into work for the next while. I may even extend it." Glimmer doesn't bother to look up. She knows Bow is trying to gain eye contact through the mirror again because he's worried about his job. Glimmer had always intended to have him transferred so she just needed to push her timeline up. "Don't worry, you're not fired. I just have decided that this project will be easier to complete if I don't have to travel so far and since I don't need a driver you might as well enjoy extra vacation time. It will be paid time as well." Glimmer pulls out her phone so she still has an excuse not to look.
"Understood… Thank you." Glimmer doesn't care to read into the tone he uses. She hates to admit how relived she feels knowing she won't have to see him and potentially won't have to in the

future either. She will say she acknowledges how it feels like a victory. She gets to choose this time and although she is sad, she knows it's better to let go before they both truly end up hating each other. She knows that it wasn't enough to love someone because although she remembered, he could not. She also understood that he had never lived a different life. After making his promise his life was always planned for each time he came back. Although it had been his choice in the beginning he never remembered. Glimmer knew it was unfair to ask someone to relive a life when there was always another choice. If she could she would have chosen something different too. Like Catra, maybe her retirement she could have been a historian or opened a café. She understood it was unfair to ask someone to live only as one thing, so when Bow started to blame her for his choice she could understand but knew she deserved better. It had taken her a long time to come to this realization but now she could find her peace in letting him go.

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

this chapter I split into two because well, it made sense to me. Hope you guys enjoy :)

Once Catra entered her home she headed straight for her office. She tried to finish up the emails she had been neglecting from other galleries and from her friends. She tried to focus on the other tasks she had ignored lately but soon found herself in the attic, or her archives as Lighthope had named it. She had a point. Catra had converted the top two floor of the house to hold her artwork that she hadn't sold, was holding for galleries and the private collection she kept for herself. Tucked away in the farthest corner was the images of her and Adora's life. Ranging from her first painting to the ones that only she and Adora would know what the moment was. She avoided that spot and instead went and looked through the images she had painted of her friends that she had pulled forward already when Lighthope had mentioned the exhibit a while back. Carefully she unwrapped the first painting. It was of Scorpia. One she had done 500 years ago when they had taken a vacation to the Solarium coast. She had painted her friend on the beach, looking less intimidating than any other image that survived of her. Catra remembers showing it to Scorpia who had cried and then scooped her up exclaiming "Oh wildcat, this is the most thoughtful thing anyone has done for me." It had taken Catra a bit to calm her down but Perfuma had heard the commotion and had run over to help Catra, although she was laughing, watching Catra scramble to be released from her friends embrace. Looking closely at the figure she had hidden in the back. She had painted Perfuma as well, but again her hair colour wasn't quite right. Catra decided to chalk this one up to the shade the hat she was wearing had cast on her hair. The next image was of Glimmer. Here she had depicted her friend on the throne. Two empty ones were on either side of hers and while most assumed Glimmer was too small for her throne Catra had painted it large enough that someone else would have easily sat

beside her. A spot for the ones Glimmer had lost. Catra didn't notice any details that seemed off in this one. A few paintings later Catra decided that it had to be a fluke. The painting Adora had found the details in appeared to be a one off that Catra had known but it hadn't made sense until it had been pointed out. Still feeling a little unsettled Catra headed to her studio. Painting had become a way for her to sort out her thoughts. She no longer needed rigorous training, although she had kept up some of her skills, it had lost the affect when there was no one there to wrap her hands after. So she sat and painted. She hadn't realized how long until she heard the first birds of the morning. Stretching her body out to relieve the cramps, she decided against cleaning up and went instead to the shower, after which she promptly fell asleep until a crash startled her awake.

"Ah! Oh no, ugh what am I gonna do now.." Catra followed the voice until she found Glimmer standing in her front entry with arms full of bags and a potted plant turned over.

"You okay?" Catra asks causing Glimmer to jump as she hadn't heard her friend come down the hall.

"I'm sorry Catra, I couldn't see it over the bags… wait am I waking you up?" Glimmer asks as she scans over Catra who is sure she looks as flustered as her friend appears to be feeling.

"Uh yeah… I started painting last night and well... time got away again." Catra scratches her head a bit sheepishly before taking the bags out of her friends arms and heading to the kitchen. Glimmer follows behind laughing and tries to smooth out the bits of Catra's hair that is sticking straight up.

"Okay let me go clean up the pot and then I'll start lunch, you must be hungry if you've just gotten up." Glimmer sorts through the bags, checking she's managed to bring everything she needs.

"Just start lunch, I'll go clean up the pot." Catra heads towards the entrance again without waiting for Glimmer to respond. She hears the thank you Glimmer throws her way before she's too far to hear. Once she's completed her task she returns to the kitchen to sit at the counter as Glimmer busies herself with making lunch. Glimmer pushes a cup of coffee towards Catra once she is seated. Catra grunts out a thank you of appreciation before she sips the drink. Glimmer prepares their meal in the comfortable silence.

Catra waits until they are settled down at the table before she asks Glimmer what's wrong.
"Oh Catra, can never hide anything from you can I?" Glimmer chuckles slightly to herself.
"Showing up for lunch is what gave it away, you wanted a sleepover which is fine but you never come over earlier unless we have something you need to discuss. Do you want to or should it wait?" Catra asks as she pushes food on to her friends plate.
"It just something isn't adding up" Glimmer hesitates.
"What? Is it something I can help you with?" Catra presses a little.
"Not really, it's just, you said Adora was tested right, for reincarnation, but the thing is the test results don't exist. There's no file from when Adora was born. Just a certificate with the date and birth but no other files, not even her parents. It's as if she was born off world and transferred here, but there's no record of that either... So she was born here but no info on the doctors or nurses and it's just odd." Glimmer looks up at her friend as she has stopped eating.
"Why did you look it up?" Catra asks, her tone giving away none of her inner thoughts.
"I'm sorry I didn't tell you… it was something the other princesses and I had agreed on a long time ago… If Adora ever came back we were gonna make sure her life was as easy as possible. We have a fund for her that would help her parents with any expenses as well as make sure all her schooling was paid for, if she needed a loan, those kind of things. Don't worry we didn't want her to become a princess and spend the rest of this life in eternity either… we just thought it was the least we could do... after everything." Glimmer sighs as she takes a sip of the iced tea she prepared.
"Would you have told me, when it was confirmed?" Catra asks, she doesn't meet her friends eyes. Unsure of the answer she wants to hear.
"Honestly, I don't know. My first instinct would to be to say no. If this had happened a few hundred years ago absolutely not. But you're doing better now. You're nightmares seem more… manageable, but I don't know. But I would have picked the way I would have thought I was saving you from more heartbreak."

Glimmer reaches across and pats Catra's arm. Catra raises her head and smiles sadly. She knows her friend would only be looking out for her. Part of her wants to yell that she should have immediately been told but after Glimmers confession the other day Catra knew it was not as simple as she thought it would have been.
"Thank you, I know you would." Catra squeezes the hand on her arm before sighing. "Well so much for a fun day. Let's finish lunch and then start those movies. I doubt either of us will be able to concentrate on other things today and we've earned this I think." Catra's words draw a small smile out of her friend as well.
"Okay" Glimmer chuckles softly. "Let's get this movie weekend started!" Glimmer quickly stuffs the rest of her sandwich into her mouth before rushing towards the den.
"Hey!" Catra calls after her. "Are you staying the whole weekend then!" She quickly finishes her food before following her friend. They spend the rest of the weekend binging movies and tv shows they hadn't gotten around to yet, while eating the various snacks they would bring during breaks. Although they both had their conversation at the back of their minds they enjoyed themselves. It was something they both seemed to have deemed could wait until the week started so for now they could just be themselves.

-Earlier that morning – Glimmer's POV

Unable to fall asleep herself, Glimmer worked through the mountain of paperwork that could have waited until Monday but she figured there was no harm in getting a head start. This way she could grab lunch with Catra next week. Although they saw each other at least every Friday, Glimmer was feeling it would be more important in the next little bit to see each other as often as possible. She just was unclear if it was more for her or for Catra. She finally stumbled upon the file Bow had dropped off earlier and the contents had left her even more puzzled. The file was supposed to be a report on Adora and the findings of her reincarnation test. About how the system had missed her. Instead she was given a basically empty file with the minimum information

required for her birth to be registered. The other papers had included information about the hospital but was void of any hospital personal that would have been involved. Even her parent's records had disappeared from the file. No reports about any incidents occurring at the hospital to hint that the file would have been altered without intentional interference. Glimmer had called the president of the hospital and requested they look into the file a bit more but had been told their records had even less information. Shift and personal details were also missing for the day. The president assured Glimmer they would look into the gap in their information but it would take a few days to go through the data as well as look into any other future visits that would have been on file.

"There are too many coincidences as well as issues to ignore hey." Glimmer thought to herself. She was unsure why someone would interfere in this way. She couldn't come up with anyone who would have wanted to hide the information. All the enemies they had faced in the past were long gone and there had been no new conflicts that could result in someone keeping Adora a secret for her safety. Perfuma had been the representation on planet during Adora's birth, but it seemed unlikely she would gain anything by concealing it from everyone. Too many things that weren't adding up. Not sure what else to do with her day, Glimmer headed over to Catra's early. She hadn't responded to any messages so Glimmer assumed she was either asleep still or painting. Either way she let herself in but overestimated her ability to maneuver the absurd amount of food she had brought over. She figured Catra hadn't done any grocery shopping for herself in a while so she had brought that along with some snacks for their movie marathon. Knocking over the pot Catra had at the front door, a gift from Perfuma that Glimmer had a sigh of relief when she realized it wasn't broken, however, she was still concerned about the plant.

"You okay?" Catra asked causing Glimmer to jump, she hadn't heard her come out to see what happened. After they sorted out the mess and Glimmer cooked them lunch, Catra had asked what was on her mind. Glimmer decided to keep the information she shared minimal, not that she had much to share but she figured

Catra didn’t need to know about the conspiracies she had swarming in her head until she had information that would indicate any of them could be correct. So Glimmer spent the rest of their weekend enjoying her time with her friend. Avoiding thinking about things that she had to wait for more information. However Glimmer, couldn’t shake the feeling her and her friend were heading into the unknown.

Chapter 5

The following Monday after their girls weekend Catra was feeling more at ease. She trusted Glimmer always had her best interest at heart, and the fact that Adora had always been a sore subject for both of them, had left her feeling a little conflicted. But she was relieved they were still able to be honest with each other. Catra had set about working on a commission that was due in a few months, unable to concentrate on any paper work that would have needed more immediate completion, she had just sat down when her phone went off. It was a text from Adora asking if Catra would like to meet for lunch later that afternoon. She had a copy of her thesis for Catra and figured since she had missed dinner she owed Catra a meal. Abandoning any ideas of getting work done today, Catra responded and with plans set to meet at 1pm that afternoon, Catra rushed to get ready. Catra was unsure how to treat their lunch. She had accepted that Adora didn't remember her so would it be okay to approach her with the intentions of winning her over. "Who says that anymore? 'Winning her over,' please you don't even know how you did it the first time how do you expect to do it again?" Catra thought to herself. She was unsure if it would be fair to ask Adora out since she didn't know the full truth about who Catra was. "Start there, tell her the truth" Catra imagined Lighthope telling her those words. Maybe it was easier to pretend the advice had come from a friend rather than taking the leap herself. Catra was still lost in her thoughts as she made her way to the museum to pick Adora up. Adora saw her first as a waving hand caught Catra's eye and a familiar smile came into view.

"What was the thoughts today?" Adora laughed as Catra smiled sheepishly.

"Uh, just thinking I actually don't know any places to eat around here other than Entrapta's but that might be too far for your lunch break." Catra scratched her neck a little embarrassed but returned the smile that Adora flashed her in response.

"That's okay, and I don't have a set time back, Lighthope said I didn't need to worry, she knew I was meeting you and I finished

everything that needed to be done today so I'm free for you this afternoon." Adora smiled even wider. "Plus I know an excellent place for lunch so follow me." Adora set out in the opposite direction Catra had come from. Close on her heals, Catra followed and soon they stood outside a small diner. It was a cozy little spot set between a flower shop and a bookstore the diner had more of a café feel but from the food that Catra could see on the tables it was clear the patrons were here for that rather then just stopping for a coffee.
'Lonnie's?" Catra asked, her head spinning a little. She almost had to laugh at this point. Even though Adora knew nothing about her past it sure had found a way to be a part of her life this time around.
"Yeah" Adora smiled "My cousin runs the place, she's right over there. Hey Lons!" Adora calls out to get the attention of the girl whose just come out of the kitchen. She waves quickly back at Adora then gesturing she would still need a second. She pulls aside the closest wait staff and passes them the tray she had been carrying directing them to the table it was headed for before coming over to see Adora at the door.
"Adora!" Her cousins wraps her into a tight hug lifting her up off the floor. After placing her back down the girl turns towards Catra. "Wow Adora you weren't kidding. She does look like the paintings. Hi I'm Lonnie, Adora's cousin. She says you guys are working on the new exhibit together, follow me though, I saved a table on the roof for you guys, the best seat in my opinion." Catra sees Lonnie wink at Adora who flushes a little but Catra doesn't notice it too much, too busy thinking about how Adora has talked about her to her cousin. "Was that a good sign? Do I need to be worried?" Catra thought to herself. They follow Lonnie up to the roof and she leads them over to a little alcove. Wisteria provided a shaded area for the table. Daffodils lined the railing and a few had been cut and placed in a small vase on the table. The view shows the street below but the awning has been converted into a garden to cover the foot traffic beneath. "Told you it was the best seat" Lonnie laughs as Catra takes in the view. Catra offers her a smile as her and Adora sit down. "What can I bring you to drink? Or should I just serve Adora's usual" Lonnie asks Catra.

“Lonnie, I’m sure Catra would like to look at the menu.” Adora sighs at her cousin but she doesn’t fool anyone into thinking she’s actually annoyed.
“Sure let’s go with what Adora usually gets.” Catra laughs as Lonnie gives a small cheer.
“Smart choice! I’ll be back shortly.” Lonnie smiles at them before heading back down the stairs. Catra and Adora smile at each other a bit awkwardly before Adora breaks the silence.
“Oh here, my thesis.” She hands Catra the paper she pulls out of her bag. “If you have any questions about anything you can let me know, I’ve done a bit more research since I wrote this… oh but I guess you would actually know more than me… well since that’s he case if you don’t mind can I ask you for your opinion on my paper? I’d like to know how close it is if that’s okay?” Adora blushes a little.
“Yeah sure, I can let you know.” Catra smiles and places the paper in her own bag.
“Okay great, thank you Catra.” Adora smiles brightly back.
“Well now that that awkwardness has passed here are you lavender lemonades. I’ll bring the food along, again shortly.” Lonnie laughs as Adora and Catra jump, not realizing she had returned.
“Thank you” Catra calls after her as Lonnie disappears back down almost as fast as she had reappeared.
“Sorry about her” Adora starts. “I told her about seeing someone who looked like Catra from the paintings so she has been wanting to meet you ever since.”
“Oh that’s fine, I don’t get it that much these days, but not many people talk about Catra from the past.” Catra chuckles awkwardly as she tries to keep her connection to the past vague, unsure of how to bring it up with Adora, who lets out a laugh at Catra’s answer.
“Oh sorry” Adora says once she sees the puzzled look that crosses Catra’s face after she laughs. “Do you really think that” Catra nods as a response. “Catra, do you not read literature these days? Well I guess historical fiction. Catra from the past is a huge character in most books. She basically is the lead in most of the popular historical romance books as well. Adora laughs some more as

shock colours Catra's face.
"Are you serious?" Catra asks a little stupefied.
"Yeah" Adora smiles as she tries to calm down. "Sorry Catra, it's just you have her name so I thought your mom had been a fan of the books." Adora reached for Catra's hand to give her a reassuring squeeze.
"Well, technically you aren't wrong. Although she gave me the name and the books reflect that. I doubt she thought they'd write books about me." This time Adora's face reflections confusion. Realizing what she's said Catra's eyes go wide as she tries to think of how she can cover up her words.
"Catra… are you saying that, you are the Catra, the one in history books, the one in the paintings? Like Glimmer?" Adora asks, seeming a little dazed.
"Um… yes?" Catra responds as more of a question.
"Well okay I came back for a good part. Here enjoy your food, Adora you will be coming back for dinner to tell me about the rest of this." Lonnie gestures towards the table. Catra and Adora jump apart as they forgot their hands were still together. "Also I guess this is on the house since you're the Catra and all, dang wanted to see how you handled the bill before I gave my cousin my blessing." Loni sighs a little before smiling and chuckling to herself. "Enjoy, and take your time, there is no rush!" Loni calls out before disappearing for a third time.
"Well okay, um also again sorry about her." Adora seems a little lost as she blinks, trying to sort her thoughts.
"Do you have any questions?" Catra asks tentatively.
"Oh are you sure? I mean you don't know me that well so I wouldn't want to intrude." Adora snaps back, concern on her face as she searches Catra's face for her emotions.
"Yeah, you would have found out eventually, I was actually planning on telling you but didn't know how… guess I did anyways, but probably could have been executed a bit better." Catra chuckles to herself and Adora relaxes a little bit.
"Okay, how about we take turns asking each other questions. Seems only fair, but I will warn you I haven't lived as long as you so my stories might be a little boring." Adora grins at her.
"Okay, you can start." Catra grins back.

“Okay, have you been Sylvatica all this time then? Like all the paintings you’ve done?” Adora asks earnestly.
“Yes, it’s always been me. Sylvatica is my last name.” Catra offers a bit more information to see if that helps Adora who sees to be puzzling over her next question. “Okay my turn, what made you decide to study art?”
“Oh um, honestly I always liked history, thought I would study that but then in the second grade we went to the gallery I work at now and I knew that I had to work there when I was older.” Adora answers easily. “Can I have my paper back?” she continues.
“What?” Catra squawks in response.
“Oh sorry, just you know if it’s always been you my theory is way off and now I’m a bit embarrassed.” Adora laughs a little nervously. “I guess in my defense I didn’t know and was only using the information I had.”
“Would it be okay if I still read it? I really want to see what you wrote.” Catra hesitates. She was interested in seeing the theories Adora had on her painting ever since she had pointed out details at their last meeting.
“Oh uh are you sure?” Adora seems a little unsure herself.
“Yes, I’ve been looking forward to it ever since you brought it up.” Catra responds quickly.
“Oh okay then yes, if you’ll still tell me what you think about it.” Adora’s smile returns.
“Deal. Okay another question, why would your cousin need to give you a blessing after meeting me?” Catra had found the comment odd and wanted it bring it up. Adpra flushes immediately.
“Oh um well I had mentioned meeting someone I was interested in but you know, you probably have someone seeing as you’re well from history…” Adora trailed off and Catra burst out laughing. Seeing Adora blush even more Catra immediately calms down.
“No sorry, it’s just that nobody ever assumes that I’m seeing someone, well maybe that’s because I rarely meet new people, but I’m glad to know you’re interested.” Catra says as she feels herself blush as well.
‘Oh really?” Adora now grins cheekily. “So if I were to ask you out for Thursday evening as a date would you want to go?”

“Yes” Catra says without thinking causing them both to laugh.
“Great! I’ll bring cake now.” Lonnie calls from the stairs leaving the two stunned once again until they smile shyly at each other.
“Guess I won’t have much to tell her about tonight.” Adora laughs and Catra smiles even wider in response.

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Later at home Catra decides to call Glimmer and let her know about todays events. After hearing her friends news Glimmer rushes over. Bursting through the front door demanding to know everything Catra laughss as her friend flops down in the living room.
“Lately your daily life has become so interesting, maybe you should move in with me so I can get updates easier.” Glimmer jokes as Catra tosses a pillow at her. “Hey!” Glimmer exclaims as it lands squarely on face.
“Truce truce!” Catra yelps back as Glimmer begins throwing any pillow she can reach. Once they return to the couches after grabbing snacks Glimmer laughs to herself.
“Look at us, doing such normal things, now spill, tell me everything.” Glimmer sets her snack down and faces Catra fully on the couch. Turning herself to fully face Glimmer, Catra tells her about her lunch with Adora.
“Wow” is all Glimmer says when Catra finishes.
“That’s it? That’s all you’re gonna say after the fuss you made.” Catra sighs but Glimmer’s grin tell her that was her intention for Catra to react that way.
“In all seriousness though, was it really Lonnie’s?” Glimmer asks.
“Yeah, I thought the same thing.” Catra laughs as she picks up her snack again and turns on the TV assuming Glimmer will be staying the night.
“Crazy” Is all Glimmer adds as she settles in beside Catra. They watch TV for a while when Glimmer nods off. Catra leaves it playing as she grabs her bag. Pulling out Adora’s thesis, Catra starts to read. It was interesting to learn about the different theories people had proposed over the years. Catra keeps reading until she comes to one passage. “By looking at these deviations in colour we can could assume this is where the student changes

position with the master. As outlined before all images to be found with these deviations were started or completed in May. It is unclear whether it is the student or the master who is signaling this change as there are no official records to compare the transition of the artist through the ages. If we work with the assumption that this change does occur along these intervals we can estimate about 27 individuals who would have held the position of “Sylvatica” in the last thousand years. As it is harder to date earlier pieces, due to the conditions needed to maintain the pieces we are unable to complete the tests needed to...” Catra starts to recall the images Adora outlined in her thesis. If she was correct about them being finished or started in May she could guess the cause. Rushing to look over her files Catra pulls out the images one by one. Lying them next to each other it appears as if they belong together. Willowy ivy climbs around parts of the image. Forget-me-knots litter corners and fields. Although some of the images are of less recognizable people, portraits she had done all featured the blonde and a tint to their eyes that shouldn’t be there. Catra couldn’t believe she had missed all these details over the years. She’ll have to go through her records as well but if it turns out to be May it was her memories of Adora bleeding through. May was the month she lost her, and the nightmares were always the worst during that month. Catra went back and finished Adora’s thesis. Glimmer had woken up to the TV still playing, but Catra was nowhere to be seen. Going to look for her friend, Glimmer finds Catra in her office, surrounded by the images and notes she’s made.

“Catra?” Glimmer asks tentatively. “Is everything okay?”

Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

> This chapter has been divided into two parts. This part touches on heavy topics such as grief and survivors guilt, and although there is nothing explicit it has the potential to be triggering. If you wish to skip this part I've written the story that it is not necessary to read this portion of the chapter and the next one will be posted shortly.

“What’s all this?” Glimmer asked when she found Catra. Her eyes tracing over the images that had been spread out. Catra had just stared as a response to Glimmer's question. She didn’t know how to explain this. How had Adora easily seen the details Catra hadn’t noticed. Having pulled out her ledgers she had found a few more of her paintings that had been done in May, ones Adora wouldn’t have known about as they were still a part of private collections or uncredited works she had hoped to forget. The only reason their records survived was because Glimmer was meticulous and had each painting thoroughly documented. Even Perfuma and Scorpia had gotten into helping her. Looking at the works that spanned lifetimes it was easy to see the details. Little parts of her past that had slipped seamlessly into her works.
“Catra seriously, what is all this?” Glimmer sank down beside her. Eyes still running along the images, reading the notes Catra had stuck beside each of them.
“I read Adora’s paper.” Is all she can offer up as an explanation for the moment.
“Okay, doesn’t exactly explain this” Glimmer gestures to the papers. “Something to do with your greatest works or something?”
“No… It has to do with her theory, about when the Sylvatica title would have been passed on to the next person… She dated it with these pieces…” Catra trails off as Glimmer meets her eyes.
“Okay, what about these pieces made her chose them.” Glimmer proceeds cautiously.
“The details of…of forget me nots and willow branches” Glimmer

nods encouragingly not sure what her friend means about the details so she waits for her to continue. “They all are started or completed in May.” The realization comes to Glimmer now.
“Oh” is all she says before pulling Catra into her embrace as they settle in the middle of the pages.
“Yeah” Catra returns the hug. Catra doesn’t know how long they sit there for until Glimmer final stands up and offers her hand to help Catra up as well. Glimmer quietly picks up the papers and returns them to their proper spots before she smiles gently at Catra.
“I’d still like to read her paper if that’s okay.” She shuffles the papers in her hand. Catra can see the notes she’s made in the margins.
“Yeah, I’m sure Adora would like that too.” Catra weakly returns the smile.
“I… I think I’m going to go visit my parents today… would you like to come as well?” Glimmer wrings the papers she holding a little.
“Yes, I’d like to go with you. Let me go shower and get changed first.” Catra tries to smile more and although it seems tired still, Glimmer relaxes.
“Good idea. I’ll do that too. Let’s go in about an hour, I’ll make something for us to eat as well before we go.” Glimmer smiles a bit more too, although it appears more like she's trying to comfort herself. They part ways to get ready and Glimmer makes them a quick breakfast before they head towards the memorials. Stopping by to pick up flowers, both of them pick out two bouquets. Once they reach the memorials, Catra and Glimmer head towards her parents. Catra helps Glimmer clean up the site, brushing away fallen branches before they replace the flowers that have wilted. One bouquet was still okay so they rest their flowers on either side. Catra quickly says her respects before she parts ways with Glimmer who remains to talk to her parents. Grasping the second bouquet Catra makes her way towards a smaller memorial. Glimmer had converted the palace of Brightmoon into a museum so the memorials for her parents and Adora had been placed amongst the grounds while the palace itself had transformed into both a museum and a school as the monarchy had switched to a democracy with the co-council of princess to remain alongside it.

Adora's memorial had been set underneath their willow tree, a small fountain had been constructed into the seating area. Glimmer had asked Catra if she thought it would be okay to put it there as it had originally been a gift for Adora. Catra had agreed but it had taken her many years before she was able to return to their place. Now she visited every few months. Mostly when Glimmer came to talk to her parents, but sometimes she would come when the nightmares were worse. It wasn't a very common spot to find visitors, as a second more grand memorial for Adora was in Asteria so many people went there if they were paying their respects, but this meant Catra was usually left alone under the willow tree.

"Hi Adora" Catra said as she carefully placed the flowers into the fountain. Taking special care to remove enough of the stem so the flowers would easily float along the gentle current in the fountain. "It seems a little foolish to talk to you here now… seeing as we think you've come back…maybe that's not fair though, you wouldn't remember this past so can we really say it is you. Are we getting too close to the ship of Theseus?" Catra chuckles to herself. The water stirs a little bit as the fountain bubbles. Catra would sometimes pretend it was Adora speaking back to her as if she was laughing at Catra's lame jokes.

"If you have come back to me is it okay to forget this past? Create new memories where we exist. The life you deserved even all those years ago." The fountain doesn't bubble anymore, leaving Catra in the gentle silence of the breeze and flowing water. "You were always like this huh. Quiet when we should have been loud. You don't have to worry about the consequences anymore. I'm the one who has to live with them anyways." Catra laughs a little bitterly. More at the fact that she has never been able to bring herself to be mad at Adora. It had only bred anger towards herself. Always had her questioning what had gone wrong on that day and had Adora resented her for not being able to save her. She had never admitted to Glimmer but she had always wondered how Adora would have been if it had been the other way around. It was Catra's duty to protect Adora even if it had meant her life would be forfeit. Catra had hated Bow for a long time because she needed someone to blame. Why hadn't he been the one to save

Glimmer? Bow had once confided in Catra, a few reincarnations after they had finally patched up what little relationship they had had before, that he felt guilty every time he learned about their past and had asked Catra for her forgiveness. Catra had realized then it was unfair how she had always put the blame on him, how she thought he never again thought of Adora. In that lifetime they had become good friends and Catra had a renewed sense of loss when he left that life. A pick up in the breeze rustles the willow branches above snapping Catra back from the past. "I have to tell you about the paper you wrote. Well this Adora wrote. She's clever like you, sometimes I forget she's lived a different life with how easy it is to talk to her. Although I'm sure you're not surprised. I bet you would even have laughed at how often I paint our willow branches… though they meant something different then, than they do now." Catra hesitates, it had never been this hard to talk to Adora before. The first time she had come she had barely gotten words out but even then she knew what she wanted to say. "I guess I don't officially know if it is you or not. There are no records…Is it strange though. That I am sure it is you. Ever since I saw your eyes I knew it had to be you. But you still come to me in dreams…which one of you is the one I've made up? I've never found you before and I have looked, you know that don't you? Why did you come now? Have you decided to end this limbo or have you come as a reminder for what has happened and what will never be? I feel guilty. I want you to feel the same in this lifetime as you did back then. If you remembered it would be easier wouldn't it? Like all these years you had just been asleep but have woken up for me. Is that too selfish of me? How do I face you now… now that I realize how haunted I still am… I don't know if it's possible to forget you to learn about you now, but if you've come back can I take it that it was for me? Or are you back for the life you deserve and we should never have met?" The fountain remains silent and it's as if the wind has stilled as well. The enclosed area holding its breath.

"Catra, I've finished so I'll wait for you whenever you're ready. There's no rush" Glimmers voice cuts the silence and the sounds return.

"It's okay" Catra responds. "I'm good to go now… if you want a

moment with Adora I can leave you for that." Catra pushes through the branches and meets her friend.
"No" Glimmer smiles meekly at her. "I'm okay this time, but thank you." They head back towards the car. Glimmer notices the dark mood that seems to have settled over her friend. "Catra…is everything okay?" She asks gently.
"Hm… oh uh yeah…Just thinking a little bit about the meeting I have tomorrow. I'm not sure what I'm going to say." Catra's not sure if her friend will buy her half-truth.
"I can help you if you need it. I'm already taking the day off today, so we can do whatever, whether that's just hang out or you do work and I sit and watch you, it's totally up to you." Glimmer laughs a little and it grows when Catra joins her. Glimmer seemed to always try to make Catra feel better, even when she didn't know what was wrong. Catra had thought about talking to Glimmer but she wasn't sure if she wanted to open that side of herself up to anyone. Catra had tried therapy in the beginning. Scorpia and Glimmer had all but handcuffed and locked her in with a therapist when the dreams were bad. Catra had worked with a few before she had found one that had helped her but it had been a few years since she had passed on and Catra hadn't found someone since. She thought it may be time for her to start searching again.
"Hmm let's watch old movies, maybe I can twist some of their plots into an interesting story at least. Help Lighthope create a romance worthy of being painted." Catra smiled a little.
"Okay that works for me." Glimmer squeezed her hand. They spent the rest of the day watching films from different periods. Catra couldn't say she fell asleep feeling a little lighter or hollow that night.

Chapter 7

Catra had been dreading Wednesday. Another meeting with Lighthope and Adora to discuss paintings Catra wasn't sure she had answers for. So here she was about to head into the meeting. Waiting by the painting she couldn't help but visit whenever she went to the museum. This time Adora looked less happy, as if the years had finally started catching up to her and the promises they made and broke were taking a toll.

"Thought I'd find you here" Adora's bright voice brings Catra's attention to her. "I thought I'd check, I'm just on my way to grab coffee for the meeting if you want to come, or I can meet you at the meeting room. I figure you already knew the way before I showed it to you last time." Adora laughs at her own little joke which causes Catra to smile.

"I'll come with you." Catra glances one last time at the painting, it's her own eyes that catch hers this time. She remembers feeling a bit uneasy but proud as the painting was taking place but now her eyes seem to be calculating her moves with a solemn expression. As if she knows how everything ends and even now there's nothing she can do to change it.

"Did you get a chance to look over my paper yet?" Adora asked, breaking the silence on the walk back to Lighthope's office.

"Uh, oh yeah I did." Catra says as she continues to face forward. Unsure of how to meet Adora's eyes.

"And? What did you think? Obviously I was wrong with you know…thinking you were multiple people and all but other than that how was my theory?" Adora seems to have caught on that Catra won't meet her eyes as she faces forward as well as they approach the office. Catra hesitates once they reach the door. Hands twisting together as she searches for what to say.

"You were right about the pieces though. Not that it signified a change in person but all the paintings had been done in May. Even the ones you couldn't date…I checked my records and it shows the dates for those ones… May also holds significance, just not what you thought it meant." Catra fiddles her hands a bit. Hoping she's not giving away something she doesn't wish to share

but also enough that Adora could be satisfied with a half answer.
“Ah, well that’s good, at least I was only half wrong, but to be fair, in my defense, not many people would come to the conclusion that you lived for hundreds of years.” Adora opens the door and offers Catra a smile just as bright as the one she had greeted her with.

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The meeting had progressed smoothly. The art work Scorpia had sent had arrived and they were quickly able to write up a description and story to add to the exhibition. However, all too soon for Catra it came time to discuss the piece of Perfuma.
“I’d like to remain anonymous for this painting” Catra had said on the phone earlier when Lighthope called to check in before the meeting.
“Are you sure?” Lighthope had only asked because her friend had sounded a bit hesitant.
“Yes, we can also go with Adora’s story of the painter being in love with the child of a family in Solarium. I’ll bring paper with the facts in case anyone questions it a bit. We can say that the painters name was lost to time and the family who donated the piece wishes to remain anonymous as to preserve the identity of the inspiration.” Catra had reaffirmed as she gathered the pages she would need later.
“Okay, we can let Adora know during the meeting and have her write up something romantic for it. I’ll see you later then.” Lighthope had ended the call and Catra wondered if people would easily believe the story they were hiding behind.
“All that’s left now is the final piece of Perfuma. Adora, we were unable to obtain the identity of the painter as it seems to have been erased from any paper work and the family that donated wishes to remain anonymous as your story was pretty spot on. So if you could do the write up for this piece as well as think of some names we can suggest to the family to choose from, as it is known as a portrait we obviously cannot use the real name for the time being.” Lighthope had guided the conversation during the meeting having Catra only comment when necessary to fill in the blanks that neither her nor Adora had been able to fill.

“Okay, is there anything else I can help with?” Adora asked as she added to her list of things to do.
“No, I think we are done for the day, we just need one more meeting to discuss this final write up before we start the instillation process. Thank you Catra for coming in and helping with the pieces, and thank you Adora for your help as well. Next time we meet I don’t think you need to be here Catra, but you do have to come to the opening.” Lighthope smiled at her friend, who returned it easily. It had become a standing joke between the two of them that Catra only attended shows and exhibits that Lighthope personally worked on. Catra rarely made public appearances and usually waited until shows had been underway for at least a couple of days, but Lighthope always insisted that they show up together so she had someone to gossip with throughout the night.
“Yeah, yeah, just send the invitation, as well as one for Glimmer because I’m sure she’ll keep track better than me.” Catra packed up her belongs and started towards the door.
“Okay well until next time then.” Lighthope waved as the two of them went out the office door.
“Do you mind if I walk you out?” Adora asked as the door swung shut.
“Oh, uh, you don’t have to. Not if you’re busy, I don’t want to interrupt your day.” Catra tripped over her words a bit.
“It’s not an interruption and if it was, I’d gladly take it.” Adora laughed gently and smiled reassuringly at Catra.
“Oh, okay then.” Catra smiled in return.
“So do you have any ideas what to name this piece?” Adora asked as they made their way towards the museum entrance.
“What? Um, no… naming pieces has never been my strong suit… I usually ask Glimmer or if I need a more poetic title my friend um Perfuma… she’s better at those…” Catra trails off as Adora chokes on her laugh.
“Sorry, it’s just sometimes I forget that all the Princesses of legends would still be around seeing as you and Glimmer are. You also seem so well adjusted that I forget that you grew alongside everything not with it established.” Adora grins to herself as she shakes her head.

“Ah, yeah, I guess that would be something strange. Most people I meet now already know about everything for years so learning it is probably a bit shocking.” Catra offers as she awkwardly tugs at the back of her hair so she can stop wringing her hands nervously.
“Hm I wouldn’t say shocking just one of those, huh moments where you don’t give too much thought to it until someone points it out.” Adora replies and ruffles her hair a bit, which seems to relax Catra as she lets out a breath she hadn’t realized she was holding. “I do want to ask if you’re still on for tomorrow evening though?” Adora straightens out, setting her mouth into kind but firm smile.
“Yes” Catra says a little too quickly and perhaps a bit too loudly but Adora smiles fully at this. “I should warn you though… I haven’t really done this, so I’m not sure what to do.” She smiles ruefully at Adora.
“That’s okay, how about then you come and pick me up after I’m done work and then we can go from there?” Adora offers a quick solution.
“Are you sure? You don’t mind me coming here?” Catra is unsure if Adora is just being nice.
“Not at all, that way I get to see you sooner.” Catra wonders how Adora appears so calm when she herself is so awkward.
“Okay then.” Catra reaffirms and smiles hoping to convey her emotions.
“Okay, see you tomorrow then Catra. Have a good rest of your day.” Adora smiles once more before she heads back in. Catra watches through the window until she sees Adora round the corner that leads towards her office.
“Okay now what” Catra thinks to herself as she pulls out her phone.

Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

> If anyone is still around sorry for the wait... um life has been life and this was supposed to be done like 2 months ago so yeah here you go! Apologies for typos and grammar for some reason I like to upload this at like 3 am so yeah

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Hello my dear friend, how may I help you with your existential crisis at this time?" Glimmer answers the phone after the second ring.
"Help, I don't know how to date and tomorrow I'm meeting Adora." Catra squawks as Glimmer chuckles on the other end of the line.
"Well fear not my friend, for I can actually help in this department. Are you home or out?" Glimmer responds as Catra hears a bit of shuffling on the other end of the line.
"Out, at the museum." Catra looks around as if she expects Glimmer to appear at any moment.
"Perfect, I'm at the office, come on over and by the time you're here I'll be done for the day so we can help you plan for this date tomorrow." Glimmer whispers something to someone on her side of the line as Catra starts in the direction of her office.
"Thank you, are you sure you can take more time off though?" Catra asks out of concern for her friend who seems to have given up on her rigid schedule.
"Of course, what's the point of living this long if I have to stick to the same thing every day. Now I'll see you when you get here." Catra barely manages to utter an 'okay' before the line drops. At the office Catra is buzzed in immediately by the receptionist. Catra notices a new secretary outside of Glimmers office where Bow usually sits. She thinks she should bring that up with her friend as she passes through Glimmers office door.
"One second, just have to finish this email and then I am yours for the rest of the day." Glimmer says without looking up as the

door swings closed behind Catra.
“There’s no rush… honestly… I’ll be fine, right…” Catra sinks down on the couch in Glimmers office. Head settling onto her hands as she hears Glimmer laugh from her seat.
“Catra, I must say I am enjoying seeing this side of you. We’ve been through a lot but never girl troubles.” Glimmer stands up and walks over to her. “We can head up to my apartment but if you’d rather deal with this here we can practice in my office. Can even call in Callie to help if you’d like.” Catra groans out of embarrassment at her friends teasing. She knows she means well but as she had said, they’d never dealt with girl troubles seeing as Catra hadn’t met anyone since Adora all those years ago and then… well they had technically been on opposite sides hadn’t they.
“What do you even do on dates? Is there new courting rules I should be aware of?” Catra wonders out loud as they make their way up to Glimmers apartment.
“Well, it’s not called that anymore and it’s not as much pressure. No chaperons needed now, but I guess you never had that problem as you were supposed to be the chaperon.” Glimmer laughs as her friends face flushes. “Honestly, just have a conversation. Ask her things about herself, if she likes you she should ask things about you too. This time you can complement her, tell her she has pretty eyes or you’re impressed with how educated she is.” Glimmer opens the door for them and they head in.
“Would it be alright to bring her flowers? Is that something people still do?” Catra asks as they settle into the living room.
“That sounds like a lovely idea Catra, now let’s pick out the ones you would like to give and then we can study.” Glimmer beams excitedly at her friend.
“Why do I feel like I should be concerned.” Catra fakes a wince at her friends beaming face.
“You should be, because now I finally have the excuse to have the rom com marathon you always insist we avoid!” Glimmer laughs as her friend groans before joining her along in laughter.

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Walking up to the gallery Catra wondered if she had made the right call in bringing along a bouquet. It ended up being a bit larger than she had anticipated but the florist had kept suggesting flowers that went with the theme and Catra couldn't bring herself to say no. So carrying the pink and yellow flowers had earned her a few stares but as soon as Adora came into view the smile she flashed was worth.
"Here I was worried you would have been waiting by the painting but I didn't check before I came outside. Glad I found you so easily." Adora smiles as she notices the blush rising in Catra's cheeks.
"Oh yeah…um sorry I was late… I got a little tangled up… Oh here, these are for you." Catra offers up the flowers which causes Adora's grin to widen.
"Nonsense, you were right on time and thank you, these are lovely." Adora brings the blooms closer to her face. "I was thinking" Adora says as she lowers the flowers back down, "that we could go for a picnic. We just have to make a quick stop at Lonnie's, I already ordered so I hope you like it, and then we can head over to the gardens. I won't lie Lonnie insisted on this idea when I was brainstorming so if you don't like it I have back ups like we can go to a movie or there was an glass art studio that could be interesting but I wasn't sure how much talking we could do at those and now I'm rambling, so what do you think?" Adora blushes but her smile doesn't falter.
"I think a picnic sounds great, thank you for putting in this much effort." Catra wants to reach out for her but she stops. She doesn't know Adora's boundaries yet and besides, they have time.
"Ah it was the least I could do." Adora grows a shy before slightly shaking herself. "Okay let's go get dinner then." She offers her arm for Catra who accepts as they make their way towards Lonnie's.
"Well look who it is, your order is almost ready it will be just a moment more." Lonnie smiles at them once they enter the store. It's a quieter evening but it seems like they're just beating the rush as a couple comes in quickly behind them. Lonnie leads them towards a table and then heads towards the kitchen. Catra notices the couples in the café admiring the interior, chatting blissfully to

each other, and she wonders what her and Adora look like to the world. A little piece of history or an awkward first date. Lonnie returns swiftly with their order and with a "Have fun you two!" following them out the door Catra is lead away with Adora's hand firmly in hers.

"I usually sit under the willow tree but it isn't the best place for a picnic, so I thought we could go over near the Buddleja's since it's a little quieter there." Adora notices Catra's slight pause. 'It has to be a coincidence' Catra thought to herself. 'Willow tree's offer a bit of privacy as well as good shade so she probably liked to read there or sit out of the sun is all right?' Catra reasons. "Sure, we can go anywhere, I haven't been here before so I'll trust your judgment." Catra smiles as Adora's eyes widen.
"How have you never been? Its so close to the gallery that you practically can't not have been seeing how often you're at the gallery!" Adora shakes her head in disbelief.
"I haven't had reason to I guess, how about after we eat you can show me around so we can correct this grave offense." Catra starts to head towards the Buddleja's. Laughing Adora catches up to her. Latching on to her arm.
"I'll give you the whole tour, science facts and all, that next time you're here you will be a master tour guide." Adora winks at her causing Catra to stumble a bit earning her another laugh from Adora who tightens her grip on Catra's arm "for safety reasons" she states.

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"Thank you Catra, I had a really good time." Adora hesitates by the door. She shifts a little and Catra wonders if she wants to say more.
"Me too, it was nice, but that probably had more to do with the company." Catra flirts and receives her desired reaction as a faint dusting of blush crosses Adora's face.
"Oh Catra, don't say stuff like that too easily, how am I supposed to top it next time you let me take you out." Adora leans forward with a slight smirk as Catra feels her own face flush.
"Oh, uh that's something that you want to do…" Catra responds

dumbly as her mouth moves regardless of all the thoughts screaming at her.
“Yes, of course. But lets say goodnight now. That way I have an excuse to text you.” Adora smiles fully now.
“You don’t need an excuse… you can just talk to ma any time… although I’m not so great at responding… especially if I’m painting… I just don’t hear it.” Catra rubs her neck nervously.
“Catra, you never owe anyone an immediate response, but thank you for letting me know. Now I won’t think you’re standing me up.” Adora reaches and holds her hand giving it a little squeeze.
“Never, I wouldn’t do that to you.” Catra responds immediately, causing a flash of surprise to cross Adora's face before she breaks out into a grin.
“Okay, good to know.” Adora leans forward, placing a kiss on Catra’s cheek. “Goodnight Catra, until I see you again.” Adora smiles once more before closing the door on a stunned Catra.
Catra reaches up a hand to her cheek and notices she’s smiling. She stays smiling all the way home. Catra went to bed that night faster than she had in a long time. It wasn’t long though, until her dreams over took her sleep. They played out the familiar scene and Catra finds herself running to catch Adora as she falls to the floor. Only this time, Adora grabs her arm, pulling her down with her as blood spills from her mouth. “So much for forever alone, wasn't that your punishment for your failure?” Adora states before she plunges a hidden dagger into Catra’s chest

Chapter End Notes

Did I really wait this long to just end on the cliff hanger... yes I did sorry, but I have started the next chapter already and will try and finish this before the year is over

Chapter 9

Chapter Notes

> Okay well I'm hoping to wrap this up in two more chapters but we will see. Hopefully they are up soon but honestly don't know where the time goes. Did not proof read so enjoy. Brief mention of gore if you'd like to skip it please start at the Glimmers POV line.

Catra wretches awake. She works to steady her laboured breath as she gets shakily to her feet. She finds herself in her studio and starts to paint. By the time she is finished the sun has well past risen and a text from Glimmer asks her to meet for lunch in an hour. Catra surveys her work. It’s a portrait of Adora. Only this time it’s not beautiful. Adora is smiling a polite smile while blood drips from her mouth. She looks like she is lounging but the closer you look you would notice she is slumped a bit. An arrow and more blood drip from her chest. Her eyes are wrong though. They look angry making the polite smile more like a sneer the longer she looks. “So much for forever alone, wasn't that your punishment for your failure?” the words from her dream come back to her. Catra snaps a picture of the painting and sends it as a response to Glimmer. Glimmer replies immediately saying she is on her way. About an hour later with enough food to last a week Glimmer walks into Catra’s house and helps her off the floor of her studio and brings her to the kitchen.

-Glimmers POV-

She had expected Catra to be in a good mood so when she received the image she had been startled. Catra had never depicted Adora as anything but flawless. Even in less obvious portraits Adora was portrayed as ethereal. Glimmer immediately rushed to Catra’s with a quick stop at Entrapta’s for food. After the quick stop Glimmer didn't bother to knock but let herself in and went to find Catra, who was sitting in front of the portrait in a stupefied state. Picking her friend up she brought her to the

kitchen and set to work setting the food out and making a pot of tea. After everything was settled Glimmer asked if Catra had slept last night. “No” was all she had gotten in response. “Can I ask what prompted this painting?” Glimmer waited for her friend. Catra took a sip of the tea that had been set in front of her and then began to tell Glimmer of her dream. How it started as it always had but instead when Adora was struck she and dragged Catra down it wasn't her last words of ‘I love you’ but instead words of anger before she plunged a dagger through Catra’s heart.
“Oh” was all Glimmer could say.
“Yeah” Catra sighed in response and had another sip of her tea.
“Well I’m no expert on dreams or anything so would you like me to schedule a meeting with Perfuma? She's good at this kind of thing.” Glimmer pushes a sandwich in front of Catra who picks it up absent mindedly and takes a bite while she mulls the offer over.
“Sure, that’s probably a good idea.” Catra finishes her sandwich and reaches for another one. Pushing them closer to her, Glimmer responds with “Okay, I’ll let you know once I’ve gotten in touch, until then do you want to come and stay at my place?” Making a mental note to look through her books about dreams later Glimmer also mentally preps a list of things they should bring if Catra choses to come with her.
“I’m not sure, I don't want to bother you if I have another nightmare.” Catra tries to get out of the offer.
“It’s no bother and your studio there is still set up for you. I’ll send the house staff away unless you want them to help with something but I think it would be better for you, plus my peace of mind knowing I can make sure you’re eating, so please do this for me.” Glimmer stands to clear away the dishes.
“Okay” Catra relents as Glimmer knew she would if she asked her to do it for her.
“Okay go pack your things, not a lot, I haven't gotten rid of any of your stuff, maybe you should go through it while you stay, anyways just bring a few essentials or things I won’t have for you while I finish cleaning this up. I’ll let the office know I’m done working for the day and I can take us back to my place.” Glimmer

sends a text to update the office on the plan. She doesn't bother waiting to read the response but a quiet ding lets her know it's been read.
"Okay, I'll take a quick shower too." Catra smiles a little less glumly at her.
"Of course no rush, we should watch bad reality TV or movies and eat the rest of this once we are back at my place. I haven't had a day off in forever so I don't plan on doing anything else for the rest of the day." Glimmer smiles at her friend. Once Catra leaves she sends a message to Perfuma. Perfuma responds quickly and before Catra comes down fully showered and packed a video call with Perfuma has been scheduled for early next week with an earlier call for just Glimmer and Perfuma and promises of research on both their sides before they talk to their friend together.
The trip back to Glimmers is quiet and they don't say much as they settle in to the apartment. As promised they make their way to the tv room with as much food as they can carry. They quickly set up a simple fort of blankets and pillows before allowing the tv to select a film for them to watch. Catra regains some of her colour throughout the day but they remain very quiet except for a few comments about the films as they slowly make their way through the recommendations.

* * *

A knock wakes Glimmer up. She and Catra seemed to have fallen asleep during the last movie and thankfully the knock hadn't disturb Catra. Answering the door Glimmer is met with a familiar face.
"Hi, sorry to show up like this but I found something and well it seemed like I shouldn't wait." Perfuma pushes her way past Glimmer into the apartment. "Oh good she's sleeping. Well let's leave her for a bit. This we can discuss tomorrow, when we can have some privacy… I don't want to upset her even more." Perfuma sets her bag down gently.
"Do I need to be worried?" Glimmer asks as her eyes drift over to her sleeping friend. Worry colours both their faces.
"I don't know. But I do know that it can wait until tomorrow so it can't be completely terrible can it?" Perfuma smiles quietly as she

looks towards their friend as well. “Let’s go back in so we’re there when she wakes up. I’ll tell her that I had an unexpected need for a file so I decided to come since it has been too long since we’ve seen each other in person. That way she won’t worry as much, hopefully.”
“That sounds like a good idea.” Glimmer agrees as they head back to where Catra remains sleeping.

Once Catra wakes up the next morning she pads into the kitchen to where Glimmer is making breakfast while Perfuma is explain the best way to take care of the new daisy plant she has brought along for Glimmer.
“Good morning” Glimmer throws over her shoulder when she spots Catra coming through the door way.
“Catra! So happy to see you!” Perfuma jumps up from her seat and launches herself into hugging Catra.
“Come, tea and coffee are ready and Glimmer said food should be done in a few moments.” Perfuma leads Catra over to the table by the hand before quickly making her a cup of coffee. As she finishes Glimmer brings the waffles she’s just finished cooking over to them.
“I thought it was supposed to be a phone call..” Catra says aloud while she puts a waffle on Perfumas plate.
“It was but then I needed a file and decided I could come in person to get it so why not come and see my lovely friends who seem to be avoiding me.” Perfuma thanks her for the food while smiling. Catra rolls her eyes at her friend but she is glad to see her in person. “Next time actually come on a vacation so I don’t have to use work as an excuse to see you.” Perfuma continues, ignoring her friends antics.
“We are going down to the office later to get that file for Perfuma, would you like us to get anything while we are out?” Glimmer asks as she sits down to join them.
“No, I’ll probably just go into the studio today while you guys work.” Catra munches on her food, seeming to be a bit higher in her spirits than she was last night.
“Okay, well let us know if anything changes, nothing is too important today that we can’t come up if you need us.” They

finish the rest of their meal in silence. As Perfuma and Catra clear away the dishes Glimmer receives a text.
"Perfuma and I have to go down in about 15 minutes, they found the file you were looking for and have some other documents you may wish to look over as well. Catra you sure you'll be okay?" Glimmer asks one more time.
"I'll be fine, go do your work, I'll still be here once you guys are done." Catra tries to offer a small smile. This seems to put both Glimmer and Perfuma at ease and they head down to the office feeling slightly better than they had last night.

In the elevator ride down Glimmer shares the contents of the message she had received.
"They found the document we are looking for but there seems to be some… errors… I'm not sure how to tell you this but when we get there you should be ready."
"Well… I'm not sure what I can do but I guess thanks for the warning." Perfuma offers a strained smile. The documents are waiting on Glimmers desk when they arrive at the office. Glimmer silently passes the papers to Perfuma and watches her friend slowly read through them.

Perfuma stilled. "Scorpia was here that day. She said something weird. Seeing a face she hadn't expected. When I asked she mentioned something about someone she was sure she knew but couldn't remember. Someone she was sure she had met but no matter how hard she tried she couldn't remember. Why is her signature on the file though? It would have had to have been mine. They shouldn't have approved this without mine. I know Scorpia has the same position but I was the representative. There should have been another one if it was approved without me." Perfuma is as lost as Glimmer is. It seems as if someone else had had a hand in the tampering of the file. "Who would be able to have Scorpia take the blame though? If she saw this I'm sure she would have said something… if anything it would have been for Catra, you know how she had taken to her. I can't see her doing this to her… to any of us…" Perfuma is on the verge of tears.
"I don't think she would either." Glimmer quickly reassures her friend. Glimmer's mind is also racing. Who could have pulled this

off. Who had anything to gain from keeping Adora's rebirth a secret. Was there anything to gain? They would have been better off selling that when she was born. So had they wanted to protect her? Keep her away from Catra and the princesses? Who would still be around that would have ill will towards the princesses to the extent of keeping this secret. The list of people who had been around that long was short, even shorter if you took into account of who would have been able to bypass or trick Scorpia into helping with their scheme. Oh. There was someone who would fit. They had retired long ago but they were one of the only ones who would have the ability to pull this off. "Perfuma… I think I have an idea of who could have done this… I just don't know why…" Glimmer stares at her hands, as if they will be able to pull an explanation out of the air for her.
"Okay, well it's all we've got, so I suggest we get started with that." Perfuma reaches out and takes Glimmer's hands in hers.
"You're staying? Don't you have to get back?" Glimmer meets her friends gaze now.
"Glimmer, this is important. I know Catra and I haven't always had the best relationship but I am as much her friend now as I am yours and Adora was important to the both of you. We made it so there should never be anything urgent or important enough that we can't possibly take any time off to help one another, so yes. I am staying. I'm also going to tell Scorpia to come. She should help distract Catra while we sort everything out." Perfuma stands and walks over to her phone. Glimmer can hear a quick conversation before Perfuma returns. "Well Scorpia will be here tomorrow so why don't we go eat. I'm sure we can order in but let's see if Catra would be up to going out." Perfuma smiles at her friend before turning to go down the hall to head back to Glimmers apartment. Glimmer lets her office know they will be away for a week and if they could inform Perfuma's office as well. Silently they ride back up to their friend.

Chapter 10

Chapter Notes

> One more chapter after this! It is written so will be up as soon as I do a quick edit seeing as I continuously believe writing and editing is done after midnight

Back in the apartment Glimmer and Perfuma call out for Catra. They find her out on the terrace watering the plants.
"Oh hey sorry I didn't hear you guys come back. That was quick." Catra puts down the watering can.
"Yeah just grabbed the file and let the office know we've decided to take a vacation to the coast. Scorpia is flying in too, so when she gets here tomorrow we will head up the coast." Glimmer says as she heads towards the kitchen to put the kettle on.
"Oh why so sudden?" Catra and Perfuma follow her in and sit quietly at the counter.
"No particular reason. We have a meeting close to there so it is technically for work, however, we decided since we are travelling all that way anyways, we might as well make a trip out of it." The kettle starts to sing.
"Plus Scorpia would be really sad if she missed out so I invited her. It's like our old trips so she is very excited," Perfuma adds with a smile. "She wanted to come today but to take the week off I told her to get everything she needed done first so that she doesn't have to work on this trip."
"It will be nice to see her, but are you guys sure you can take the time off?" Catra accepts the cup passed her way as Perfuma sets some plates out on the table before sitting down, indicating Catra to follow.
"It's fine, plus we never take breaks but the whole point of our system is so that we can so no big deal. But Catra, will it be okay with the show coming up soon? Do you need to text Lighthope? I can do that, we were going to meet for lunch tomorrow so I have to reschedule anyways." Glimmer picks up her phone and starts typing a message.
"If you don't mind, I left my phone at home so maybe we should

stop there tomorrow on our way and I can grab a few things as well." Catra smiles as Perfuma passes her a muffin.
"Okay I let Lighthope know that we had to take a trip so getting in touch may be spotty for a week, also you don't have your phone at the moment so to text me if its urgent." Glimmer sends off her message and a quiet ping comes in letting her know Lighthope has agreed to also pass along the message to Adora. Sittting down with her friends, the trio spends the rest of the day enjoying each others company. They fall asleep on the couches again, continuing on the movie marathon. The next morning they are greeted by the door bell and an excited Scorpia who sweeps everyone into hugs the moment the door is open. They set out for the coast, once everyone is packed in and they quickly go to gather what Catra would need from her house. Catra doesn't know why but she chooses to leave her phone. Ignoring the sense of dread she feels, she enjoys the scenery and Scorpias constant chatter as they make their way to the beach house. The house is how they all remember it. Bright and open with a gentle breeze that carries the scent of the ocean. They all head towards their rooms before reconvening in the kitchen for lunch.
"We just have a meeting in the morning tomorrow. Catra will you be okay or do you want Scorpia to stay with you?" Glimmer tentatively starts the conversation. They had all agreed not to tell Catra much about the meeting until they were sure of the consequences it would bring.
"I'll be fine, I can paint on the beach, haven't done that in a while so it will be nice. Plus I won't have to feel guilty about zoning you guys out if you aren't here," Catra laughs as she earns sighs from her friends. They are used to her tuning them out while she paints.
"You sure wildcat? I don't mind." Scorpia picks at her plate a bit.
"Totally, we have a whole week together, plus it is for work so technically none of you are on vacation until it's over so we can have fun after that," Catra says earning more sighs from her friends but they are all smiling.
"Okay, well as long as you're sure, you can also change your mind up until we leave, no harm done."
"Thanks you guys, but I'll be okay." They all return back to their

lunch and the conversation dissolves into Scorpia retelling the time Catra, Perfuma and her had come here and when she had lost Catra in the woods, who Perfuma found very easily but still scolded Scorpia for not realizing her friend had not said a word for over an hour. Catra swears she didn't get lost on purpose, but the story has them all in stitches none the less.

On the car ride over Perfuma and Glimmer fill Scorpia in on their findings.
"I don't remember this and I wouldn't have signed off, I wouldn't do that to you." Scorpia looks as flustered as they expected her to be. Perfuma reaches for her hand and grasps it between hers.
"I know, but we thought you should still be included in the following conversation." Perfuma squeezes her hand and Scorpia seems to relax a bit.
"Have you guys said anything to Catra yet?" Scorpia offers a small smile to Perfuma.
"No, we were planning on telling her after we know how this conversation goes. Even then though, I'm not sure what we will have to tell her." Perfuma sighs. She had given up hope for her friend returning and if she had, she was angry that someone robbed them of the opportunity to do right by her in this life. The trio pull up to a house on a cliff. They recognize the person sitting on the deck.
"You think she's behind this?" Perfuma isn't too surprised but Scorpia seems to have been caught off guard.
"Yes, but I suppose we will have to ask her. I hope she has decent tea at least." Glimmer leaves the car first. Perfuma reaches again for Scorpia's hand and leads her out of the car behind Glimmer.
"Hello, to what do I owe this pleasure?" Shadoweaver greets her unannounced guests.
"We have something to discuss, shall we go inside for a cup of tea?" Glimmer plasters a smile on her face.
"Sure," Shadoweaver narrows her eyes and a polite smile morphs her face. "Follow me." Shadoweaver brings the trio into a small solarium. Tea is brought in and the four of them sit down.
"What can I help you all with?" Shadoweaver picks up her tea.
"We are here to discuss Adora." Glimmer also picks up her tea but

her blunt delivery earns her flabbergasted stares from her companions.
“Oh? And what exactly would you like to know?” Shadoweaver remains unfazed.
“Have you ever manipulated the past life records of an individual?” Glimmer sets her tea down.
“Hmm, that’s not the term I would use. I think you meant to ask have I ever falsified past life records. Am I correct?” Shadoweaver now sets down her cup and meets Glimmers eyes.
“You are.”
“Seeing the company you have brought today, I believe you already have the answer no?” Glimmer rises from her seat.
“Tell me why.” Glimmer stands over her. Gone is the polite diplomatic person she was in the past. Shadoweaver realizes how much she resembles her mother now. Allowing a small portion of her power to seep through to intimidate. Shadoweaver only sighs. They had never gotten along in the past so she didn't see the point in threats. They would either believe each other or they wouldn't.
“I did it for Catra. I know you won’t believe me but it’s true. I raised her. I know her. I know what Adora meant to her. How she hasn’t gotten past what happened. So when I was given the chance I did what I thought would save her. Adora most likely won’t proceed with the ceremony for everlasting life and you can’t undo Catra’s… I thought if there was a chance that Catra could move on it would be if Adora never came back. I assumed you or one of the others would have told her.” Shadoweaver picks up her tea again.
“You were the nurse then?” Perfuma asks quietly from Glimmers side.
“Yes. How else do you think her parents would have named her that when they received a report that she had no previous lives. I thought she deserved at least her name along with the other things I could offer. Don’t worry she was always taken care of… She was important to me too.” Shadoweaver meets their gazes.
“Thank you for your honesty.” Glimmer turns quickly, leaving. Perfuma offers a small nod before following her out with Scorpia close behind. Shadoweaver watches them leave out the window

and returns to her tea once more. Once the trio is back in the car Scorpia is the first to break their silence.
“So, what are we going to tell Catra?” Silence once again consumes the car.
“I guess we have a bit of time to figure that out. But I don’t think we should wait that long to tell her.” Perfuma sighs and looks out the window, lost in her thoughts.
“I agree, I guess we have to tell her the whole truth. I’m not sure how that will go, so if you two would like to leave I can tell her on my own.” Glimmer thinks back on their conversation.
“Nonsense, we are all her friends, we will be there for our friend.” Scorpia snaps the other two back into the present.
“Thanks you guys. Well hope you are okay with a potentially strained week.” The three of them share small smiles before coming up with a plan to talk to their friend once they return.

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Catra could tell something was off once the group returned. They were somber as they quietly sat for dinner. The conversation never really veering too long on a topic and never anything that would lead to their afternoon meeting. They had agreed on a campfire that night so while they shuffled their way through the motions Catra decided to break their silence.
“You guys want to talk about this afternoon?” She pokes at the fire. Feeling her friends tense beside her she continues more as a way to avoid eye contact than necessity to keep the fire going. “I can save you the trouble of breaching the subject. Shadoweaver called while you were on your way back and explained the conversation from her side. So now I want to hear yours seeing as she’s the biggest liar I know.”
“Wait Catra, she called you?” Perfuma is the first to speak but she still appears in shock as to Catra’s reveal.
“Yeah, I figured she just wanted to look good for coming clean rather than you guys exposing her. I know you’re worried… since the painting so I understand. I also want to apologize that I scared you guys like that.”
“How are you feeling about that?” Glimmer now speaks. Readying herself for her friends rage.

“Honestly, I think I knew but didn’t want to believe it because it meant someone had kept a secret from me. I also apologize because I suspected you guys but when Shadoweaver called I realized you guys probably only also realized what might have happened and I know we don’t talk much about that time, but I know you guys also cared for Adora and I know you wouldn’t hurt me like that.”
“You’re handling this surprisingly well. Even Glimmer snapped.” Scorpia chimes in but Perfuma places a hand on hers to keep her from saying more.
“Don’t worry, Shadoweaver can’t bewitch through the phone. She’s tried before, but I’m choosing to see what you guys have done for me, like this spontaneous trip. I will say when I first heard I was very upset but seeing as it took you guys a few hours to get home I was given the space to see the bigger picture. So now that it is out in the open, can we please enjoy the rest of our trip? Let’s use it to show shadoweaver she didn’t break us up or whatever her goal was.” Catra smiles at her friends who relax. They quietly dissolve into conversation about their past trips and how they really should make it an annual thing with everyone who can make it. When they finally make it to bed Catra reflects on the conversation with Shadoweaver. She hadn’t told her friends everything. At the end of their conversations Shadoweaver had told Catra she did it for her. Adora although she was her, had no memories. Never shown signs of knowing who she was or who anyone else was so she had kept her hidden. She said it was for the life she should have lived and that Catra had sacrificed so much for. It doesn’t do much to help ease the pain and once she falls asleep she is greeted with the dream she cannot outrun.

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The week passes to quickly for the group and they soon find themselves saying goodbye and sending Scorpia and Perfuma to their respective ships. After, Catra and Glimmer head to Glimmers place. Catra has decided to stay there until the gallery opening is over as the commute is a bit easier and she already has everything there. They spend the weekend doing nothing really. Catra refuses to talk about how this final week of prep will go. She

hasn't answered any messages from anyone, saying she can do it after the gallery opening since nothing is too important. If it was they'd call Glimmer which they both know is true. Then all to suddenly its Monday and the gallery opens on Friday.

Catra manages to avoid Adora for the most part. A few times they have brief conversations about the artwork and where everything should go, but they are never alone. Catra remains glued to Lighthopes side and if she's not, she's nowhere to be seen. The last bit of prep goes smoothly and then its Friday night. Trading their usual dinner at Entrapta's, Glimmer and Catra walk into the event.

Glimmer watches her friend and looks for Adora, who is never anywhere insight until Glimmer walks out of the bathroom.
"Oh hi Adora, the event is lovely, you did a very good job."
"Oh Glimmer, thank you. It really was a team effort plus with art like this its not hard to convince people of its beauty. Um have you seen Catra?" Adora kneads her hands.
"Oh I just left her, hmm looks like she's not there. I'm sure she's just been pulled into conversation with someone or Lighthope has asked her to help woo a patron. Is everything okay?" Glimmer presses. Unsure as her friend hasn't mentioned anything but with how Adora is fidgeting she's worried.
"Oh um, I'm not sure. She hasn't really talked to me since the date and I know you guys had that trip so I didn't expect anything but even once she got back it seemed like she was avoiding me. I just want to know if something happened." Adora sighs.
"I'm not sure, you'd have to talk to her. She hasn't said anything to me. Sorry." Glimmer tries to give a reassuring smile.
"It's okay, thank you. I do want to talk to her but I can't seem to find her to ask. I'll keep trying. Enjoy the rest of your evening." Adora starts to pass by.
"Adora, the invite to dinner on Friday still stands. If you can make it next week I would really like that. If not let me know what week would work for you." Glimmer knows she should ask Catra first but she also needs to talk to Adora in a place she knows won't have anyone wanting to keep more secrets.
"Oh, I should be free. I'll double check my calendar but that

should work. Thank you for the invite.” Adora smiles at her.
“No problem, it will be my pleasure. Also I hope you find Catra, I’ll let her know you are looking for her.”
“Thank you.” Glimmer is gifted a bigger smile. She quietly thinks to herself ‘it’s the least I could do for you guys’.

Glimmer had found Catra shortly after. Letting her know Adora was looking for her, Catra changed the subject. When the party was winding down that’s when Adora finally cornered Catra. Catra had fled to the garden to wait out the ending speeches when she heard Adora call out from behind her.

“Catra, oh I have been looking for you all night. You’re very hard to track down.” Adora smiles at her and Catra can’t help but see her dream.
“Oh yeah, I try to avoid Lighthope as much as possible because she always has someone who wants to talk to me so I’m never in one place too long.” Catra awkwardly smiles back.
“Ah okay, I thought you were avoiding me. I was wondering if something had happened.” Adora sighs in relief. In a moment of clarity Catra knows what she has to do.
“I’m sorry Adora but I can’t see you anymore.” Catra attempts to walk away before her resolve crumbles. Sure the delivery could have been eased into but Catra just couldn't bear to pretend. After coming to terms that this Adora was her Adora in a past life she also realized why Shadoweaver had kept it a secret. Here she was being dragged back into the world that had taken her. She had always wished that Adora could live an average life, happily unaware of the pain from the past and she also couldn’t bear to keep secrets from her. She had to let her go if she was to get the life she deserved.
“Wait Catra, I don’t understand.” Adora grasps her arm before she is pushed off. “Did I do something wrong? I don’t understand what happened between the end of our date and now. Don’t you think I deserve to know?” Adora looks on the verge of tears but Catra can’t listen to the part of her that wants to wrap her in her arms and ask for forgiveness. It’s not something she can give. She doesn’t know what Catra had promised her all those years ago.
“I’m sorry” is all Catra manages to get out and tears finally fall

from Adora’s eyes. ‘I’m sorry that I forgot about our promise. I won’t burden you in this life’, Catra promises her in the silence she leaves behind.

Chapter 11

Chapter Notes

> Okay final Chapter! Thank you to everyone who read this and stuck around. I didn't think it would take me this long to finish the piece and a few parts do feel rushed so I may come back and edit but for now I hope you can enjoy the story. Again thank you for the comments and kudos! I hope you enjoy the end of the story

Catra returns to Glimmers apartment and doesn't answer her friend when she calls to ask if she wants tea. Instead, she heads straight to her studio and closes the door. She knows she will have to talk to her friend about what has happened but for now. When it's still too fresh. She just wants to paint. Again, she doesn't notice the time pass until she can hear the birds outside and the morning sun has sent a soft glow across the room. She decides to sleep for a bit and doesn't come out of the room until a little after lunch. Glimmer is waiting in the kitchen with a cup of tea and lunch for Catra. Smiling sadly at her friend she sits down across from her, and they eat in silence. Once they finish Glimmer decides her friend has had enough time alone.
"Would you like to talk about what happened last night? You returned in well I don't know not quite a state, but you didn't say anything, just went to your studio. So what happened?" Glimmer pours more tea into their cups.
"I ended it with Adora last night. I told her I couldn't see her anymore." Catra hears the thunk of the teapot as her friend drops it.
"I'm sorry, you'll have to repeat that for me, because it sounded like you decided something on your own again." Glimmer sits back and stares at her friend.
"I don't see how that really is your concern." Catra starts to say, narrowing her eyes.
"Oh really. The first person you decide to see in how many years and had a wonderful date with. Then the night after a gallery opening with said wonderful girl ends, you're back in the studio

without saying a word. I just want to know why." Glimmer stands her ground.
"How do you know the date went well? We didn't talk about it." Catra counters.
"Well Adora mentioned it a bit to me, so I assumed if it went bad she wouldn't have been trying to find you all night and she didn't look like she wanted to end the relationship with you. So, tell me why you are thinking this way. Please." Glimmer softens.
"I don't know what to tell you. Honestly it wasn't my intention but… when we finally talked I realized that I had wanted to pick up where we left off. I'm in love with her but also still the past her. I had hope that there was still the part of her that had loved me from then as well. There were so many similarities that I thought she remembered something. I didn't say this, but Shadoweaver had told me that she had kept an eye on Adora to see if she ever remembered anything. If she had she would have brought us to her. But she never did. I also realized that if she got involved with me, she would be dragged back into the world that she didn't want. I've seen what it has done to Bow and I didn't want to burden her with that. I'm okay being temporary in her life this time. I got to see her happy and that's all I needed." Catra sets her cup down so her friend can't see her hands shaking.
"I guess I can respect that. I think though you should have asked her if she remembered anything. I invited her to dinner to ask that. I was going to let you know because if she did, we have things in place but if not, we would have needed to decide what to do. Now that we know she can come back we should have a council meeting to decide if we should keep her a secret in the future as well. I'm sorry my friend. I understand why you did what you did. But I have to say I don't agree. I think you like this Adora too, but if you can't separate them, well I don't blame you for choosing this. I should have done the same long ago." Glimmer stands up and pats her shoulder. "I guess dinner will have to wait this week though. I won't cancel on her. You're welcome to come if you want to." Glimmer leaves the room without waiting for a response. She heads down to her office to schedule a meeting with everyone.

The meeting took place a couple of days later. Everyone was waiting on the call until Glimmer and Catra joined in. They had argued a bit over Catra's attendance. Catra had not want to come but Glimmer assured her it was unnecessary to have or voice her opinion if she didn't want to say anything, but everyone had asked her to be there as they didn't want her to have to get any of the information second hand, even if it was going to come from Glimmer.
"I guess I'll start the meeting now," Glimmer smiled at her friends once they had connected to the meeting. "On top of discussing Adora's return, I think we need to go over the protocols for past life tests once more as there was a breach in it that left us with this discovery. But we can do that at a later date. Now for the pressing matter, how should we approach this information that Adora has returned?" Glimmer pauses. Perfuma and Scorpia hold their tongues. Although they have also had the most time to think on the matter, they were unable to find a solution. Entrapta speaks up first.
"I'm not sure if anyone else has anything to say but maybe we should include Adora on this? I mean she's had a life and if we wanted her to drop everything, she should be able to say no?"
"I agree, if she wants, we will follow her lead. I think she should be involved." Mermista nods as she backs up Entrapta.
"Do we not think this may affect her negatively though? I mean we made it part of the curriculum so everyone knows what happened, would it not be strange to find out your past now?" Frosta starts. "Shouldn't we ask someone who has experienced it? Like Bow?" All eyes quickly flutter to Glimmer before returning to Frosta.
"Bow has been transferred to Nettossa's area, unfortunately they were unable to make today's meeting, however, I do not believe it was a problem to know, it was carrying forward what was promised in the past. As Adora never promised anything, it would be more as if she won a lottery as we set aside a pension for her." Glimmer ignores the looks from her friends. "In any case, we were going to originally tell her with the test so I don't see how that will change. However, I shall say we should not give the option of joining the council until later. She wouldn't have been offered that

until she was older so we should give it a few years. I have a dinner scheduled with her for Friday. I intended to tell her then after receiving approval." Nobody seems to be able to counter Glimmers argument. They had all agreed to those terms long ago so why would it change now. Even Catra didn't appear to be surprised or upset at Glimmers suggestion. Eventually they all agreed that Adora had a right to know, and that Glimmer could tell her. After the meeting Glimmer and Catra ride back up to her apartment.
"Are you okay?" Glimmer asks, still facing forward.
"Yeah, I had come to the same conclusion as you, I also decided I don't want to be around when you tell her. I'll go back to my place and then this weekend I think I'll head back to the beach house, stay there for a while if that's okay." Catra sighs, looking up at the ceiling.
"Of course. I'll go with you. We can go up Saturday morning if that's works?" Glmmer smiles at her friend.
"Yeah, that works." Catra smiles back.

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Dinner that Friday is just Adora and Glimmer. Adora wasn't surprised but Glimmer could see the moment her hope disappeared when she entered and saw Glimmer sitting alone.
"Come in. Please sit." Glimmer stands, she pulls the chair out beside her as Adora approaches her. "We have a lot to discuss today." Glimmer adds as Adora sits in the offered chair. Glimmer has the restaurant booked out completely as she doesn't want anyone to overhear. Once their food comes Glimmer brings up the topic of reincarnation to Adora. "Well…" She starts hesitantly, "it seems there was a problem with your test. You can retake it if you would like but I have the original results here if you would like to take a look." Glimmer brings out the documents and hands them over when Adora nods. Reading their contents, Glimmer is unable to discern the emotions on Adora's face. A few moments pass in silence.
"Does Catra know?" Adora asks still looking at the paper in her hand.
"About the results… Yes, she does." Glimmer is unsure if she

should have lied as Adora remains unmoving.
"Why then. Why isn't she here? Why did she push me away…" Adora whispers the last part, but Glimmer can sense the same sadness her friend had when she had found out about Shadoweavers involvement. Sighing Glimmer decides its time the truth was told.
"Catra thinks she's saving you. She thinks you don't remember anything from the past. But that's all she's known. She lost you and has never forgiven herself for that. She doesn't know but she talked while she was recovering from the ceremony.. she begged you not to leave her. That she hadn't broken her promise so how could you. She never loved anyone else. In all these years, no matter how hard anyone else tried she didn't even give them a first date. Not until you. She doesn't want you to be burdened by the past. She thinks if she loves you now, you in the past would think you're breaking the promise." Glimmer tells her as Adora feels the first tears on her cheeks.
"Why?" Adora breathes out. Her mind racing trying to think if there had been any clues in their conversation.
"Because she dreams of you. Every night. She relives the worst day of her life and the end of your first one. You don't remember but the last thing you said to her was the only thing she had wanted to hear you say. She had wanted it to mean forever for you… she knows that it possibly won't be the case.. which is my fault… she thinks she's tricked you into your old life that you hated." Glimmer sighs again. She can't look up from her hands anymore. She's never told anyone about what her and Adora talked about during their relationship. Adora had confessed to her at their first meeting she was in love with someone else ,but she would play her part. Sacrifice the love she carried, but she had wanted to be honest. Glimmer had been honest that night too. Saying she also had someone she loved so they had agreed that they could be friends and nothing more. Married only in the eyes of the public. Glimmer had only ever respected Adora. Even though they hadn't known each other long they had become fast friends. The only ones who knew the secrets they could never tell. When Adora died that day protecting her, Glimmer made a vow. If she ever met her again, she would do everything in her power to

give her the life she deserved.
"I do remember though." Adora's confession snaps out Glimmers attention back, drawing her eyes up again.
"What?" Glimmer asks, she's sure she's heard wrong.
"I remember" Adora reaffirms but seems to sense Glimmers hesitation to accept her statement. "I don't remember it all but pieces, Like the first time we met, well back then that is… I told you I was in love with Catra and I guess I am again. I also remember that day… I remember the arrow and Catra's face… I remember finally telling her but knowing it was too late. That I was foolish so this time I didn't want to waste time, but it seems like I was wrong. I moved to fast and lost her a second time without getting to say it." Adora can't help the tears that continue to fall.
"Tell her" Glimmer says after a moment. "Go tell Catra what you told me. That you remember."
"What, but last time I saw her she just left." Adora stammers as Glimmer sighs again, this time with slight annoyance at her friend.
"I swear you two… Look if you don't want to be with her that's fine but seeing as you are crying here and saying you remember, and I think you even said you love her so I'm saying go and tell her. Go and get the ending you two deserve if you want it. Either way I'll still be here. For both of you." Glimmer braces herself for Adora to admit she won't go. Just like Bow had wanted it to end, maybe Adora wanted too as well. To live a life that everyone else had. She deserved it, if she wanted it.
"Thank you" is all Adora says before she's running out the door. Glimmer watches the door shut behind her. 'Enjoy this life together' Glimmer says to the empty room before picking up her forgotten drink.

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Opening the door Catra is met with an out of breath Adora.
"Adora what are you doing… Are you okay?" Catra grabs her arm as Adora looks ready to topple over.
"Whew…I'm okay" Adora straightens up but doesn't pull away. "I have to tell you that I remember. I remember the promise we made all those years ago." She smiles at Catra.

"Adora… I don't know what you've read… or been told about it…" Adora wretches out of her grip.
"Just stop" She snaps and Catra shuts her mouth instantly. "I know that I was the one who broke it first, but I heard you back then and I've been working on getting back to you ever since." Adora's eyes shine and Catra can only respond in confusion. Catra hadn't allowed herself to dream of the possibility.
"How?" is all she can manage in response.
"I don't know what to tell you, but I've always had these dreams. That's why I got into history. I was twelve when they first told the story in history class. About Adora and how she died protecting Glimmer, but it was your face that I saw in the end. The one that I wanted to wipe the tears from. I thought I was crazy, but then we came here to the museum when I was sixteen and I saw that painting you're always sitting in front of, and it was like I remembered sitting for it. I could feel your hand on my shoulder and how the flowers smelt. The chair was uncomfortable, and I wanted you to be sitting beside me so I could see you as well as feel you. So yes, I have lived a different life, but it was always you. I dream of you almost every night and the first time I saw you in the museum I knew it was you I had been looking for." Adora is grabbing Catra's hand tightly as if to make her admission more convincing. Catra is at a lost for words, she hadn't believed it would be possible for her feelings to be returned by anyone other than the Adora from then, so she had resigned herself to the fact that Adora now had a different life and could be just normal like she had wanted to be. Adora was either nervous or becoming more courageous because she filled the silence that Catra couldn't. "It wasn't the first time we officially met just so you know. It was while I was doing my internship. I had stayed late one night working on something and was sent to get coffee for the group. Lighthope had said someone had stayed late in the gallery so not to be alarmed if I ran into you in the hallway. I was curious as to who was allowed to stay so late, so I detoured to try and look for you and I found you. In front of the painting. You looked like it had come to life, but instead of looking happy you looked so sad. I had wanted to run to you then, my heart begged me to go to you, but I didn't know who you were, and I honestly

thought I was hallucinating you. Because how could the girl who lived in my dreams, who was supposed to have lived centuries ago, someone who had never been reported as being reincarnated, be in the gallery looking at the painting of us. I even asked Lighthope about you a bit, but she was vague. She cares a lot about you, so she didn't say much but I looked for you a lot. That's why I took the job here. Hoping to meet you." Adora looks on the brink of tears.
"Oh" Catra breaks her silence with a stupid grin. Adora chokes on a laugh while the tears slip down quietly.
"That's all you're going to say?" Adora shakes her head but a smile creeps along her lips. Catra brings a hand to her face to wipe away the tears. Sheepishly she grins a little wider.
"Yeah… sorry I'm not the best at words and well I'm a little surprised to hear that you've been dreaming about me." Adora laughs fully at this.
"That's what you're focusing on? In all that I've said that's what you're focusing on?" Adora pulls away a little, but Catra quickly closes the distance again.
"No sorry, I did hear it all but I was worried that I was making everything up, that you seemed to be her but I didn't want to put anything on it but the fact you dream of some of our moments from then, well it makes me happy, because then… Adora, from then, came back for me but she also got to live a life she wanted, well you got to live life the way you wanted… I hope that makes sense I'm still a little confused on how this whole reincarnation thing works, you think I would know since I've met Bow a bunch of times but honestly, I don't think he knows how it works either, especially this time, he's so crabby this time around." Catra is cut off with another laugh from Adora.
"I'm sorry, you're just being so cute. You still ramble when you're nervous around me." Adora giggles while slotting her hand to fit better with Catra's.
"Can I kiss you?" Catra blurts out before she can think. She instantly feels herself turn red when Adora makes a surprised face at her. It doesn't last long before Adora's expression turns into a smile.

“I thought you’d never ask.” Adora remarks before she closes the final distance between them.

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